

MASTER
GRAMMAR

30-DAY GRAMMAR COURSE

For CSS Essay, Precis,
Comprehension,
and Correction

A practical study manual
for accuracy, formal tone,
sentence control, and
exam-ready grammar.



Structured
Lessons



Practical
Practice



Examination
Focused



CSS ESSAY | PRECIS | COMPREHENSION | CORRECTION

MASTER GRAMMAR

The 30-Day Grammar Course

A Practical Handbook for CSS Essay, Précis, Comprehension & Correction

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CSS ESSAY | PRÉCIS | COMPREHENSION | CORRECTION

How to Use This Book

This is not a reference grammar to be read once and shelved. It is a thirty-day training programme. Each day is a workout: you learn one rule deeply, apply it to CSS-style material, drill it, check yourself against the answer key, and record the single error you must never repeat. Used this way, the book retrains how you write not just what you know.

What each daily lesson contains

Section	What it does for you
Why this matters	Tells you exactly where this rule earns or loses marks in the paper.
Learn the Rule	The actual teaching explained in plain language with worked examples.
Model Sentences	Side-by-side wrong vs. right sentences, each with the reason.
Mentor's Tip / CSS Trap	The shortcut that saves time, and the trap the examiner is hoping you fall into.
Practice Set	Real sentences to fix written on CSS themes, not childish examples.
Answer Key	Worked answers so you can study alone and still be corrected.
Close the Day	Your deliverable and a short self-check to confirm mastery.

Four rules for the next thirty days

1. Study the rule before you touch the drills. Understanding precedes speed.
2. Write your examples on CSS themes governance, law, economy, education never “the cat sat on the mat.”
3. Keep the Daily Error Log (Appendix A). Your repeated mistakes are your real syllabus.
4. On review days, work under a timer and analyse every wrong answer by rule name.

DAILY TIME BUDGET

60–90 minutes of focused work, plus 10 minutes of error-log revision. If you only have 30 minutes on a given day, do the Rule and the Practice Set, and carry the rest forward but never break the chain of daily contact with grammar.

The 6-Step Daily Method

Every lesson in this book runs on the same six-step loop. Internalise it now, because from Day 1 you will repeat it without being told.

Step	Action	Question you must answer
1. Command	Learn the rule deeply enough to explain it aloud.	Can I teach this to a junior?
2. Apply	Write CSS-themed examples using the rule.	Does my example sound exam-formal?
3. Drill	Attempt the practice set without notes.	Can I do it under time pressure?
4. Correct	Check the key; diagnose each error by rule name.	Which rule did I break, and why?
5. Revise	Rewrite weak sentences for tone and economy.	Is it now formal, concise, and clear?
6. Reflect	Log the one error you must not repeat.	What is today's single takeaway?

THE DISCIPLINE THAT WINS THE PAPER

Never just write the right answer write the rule that produced it. A score alone teaches you nothing; a named rule prevents the next repetition. Step 4 (diagnosis) and Step 6 (reflection) are where the real learning happens. Most candidates skip them. You will not.

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Course Architecture

The course is a ladder, not a buffet. Early days remove basic errors, middle days build control, and the final days train examination performance. Do not skip ahead: each phase assumes the one before it.

Phase	Focus	Days	Purpose
Phase 1	Foundations of Accuracy	1–8	Remove structural mistakes before chasing style.
Phase 2	Structure & Cohesion	9–16	Build variety, precision, and smooth flow.
Phase 3	Nuance & Formality	17–22	Control tone, word choice, and formal expression.
Phase 4	Precision & Rhetoric	23–27	Edit with emphasis, economy, and cohesion.
Phase 5	CSS Mastery & Application	28–30	Perform under exam pressure with full error analysis.

THE PROMISE OF THIS BOOK

If you complete one lesson a day reading the rule, doing the drills, checking the answer key, and logging your errors then in thirty days you will recognise an error, name the rule behind it, correct it under pressure, and write with clarity and restraint. That is the entire goal.

PHASE 1Days 1–8

Foundations of Accuracy

Build the grammatical base before moving toward style. Remove the errors that cost easy marks.

Day 1 Parts of Speech Mastery

PHASE 1 · FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY · DAY 1 OF 30

Goal: Understand not only the eight parts of speech, but how a word changes its function according to its position in a sentence.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

CSS correction questions hide basic category errors inside long sentences. Once every word has a clear grammatical role in your mind, your essays become cleaner and your error-spotting becomes faster.

1. Learn the Rule

The eight parts of speech

Every English word does one of eight jobs. Learn the job, not just the label.

- *Noun names a person, place, thing, or idea: governance, Pakistan, justice.*
- *Pronoun replaces a noun: it, they, who, this.*
- *Verb expresses action or state: implement, reform, is, seems.*
- *Adjective describes a noun: weak (institutions), fiscal (policy).*
- *Adverb describes a verb, adjective, or other adverb: quickly, poorly, remarkably.*
- *Preposition shows relationship: in, of, on, despite, regarding.*
- *Conjunction joins: and, but, because, although.*
- *Interjection expresses emotion: alas, indeed (rare in formal CSS prose).*

Functional shifting (the part examiners test)

One word can do several jobs depending on where it sits. The same word is a different part of speech in different sentences. Always ask what the word is doing, not what the dictionary calls it.

- *Water the plants. (verb) / The water is polluted. (noun)*
- *The reform failed. (noun) / They reform institutions. (verb)*
- *A fast train. (adjective) / He ran fast. (adverb)*

Pronoun clarity and agreement

A pronoun must clearly refer to one noun (its antecedent) and must match it in number. Trouble arises with each, every, either, neither, and with collective nouns. These words are singular in formal English.

- *Each of the candidates has submitted his or her form. (not have)*
- *The committee announced its decision. (the body acts as one unit, so its)*

Adjective versus adverb

Use an adjective to describe a noun and an adverb to describe a verb. The common error is using an adjective where an adverb is required.

- *The policy was implemented quickly. (not quick it modifies implemented)*
- *The argument is economically sound. (adverb modifies the adjective sound)*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>Each of the candidates have submitted their forms.</i>	Each is singular: Each of the candidates has submitted his or her form.
Weak	<i>The policy was quick implemented.</i>	Quick describes nouns; use the adverb: quickly implemented.
Incorrect	<i>Neither the minister nor the secretaries was present.</i>	With nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject: were present.
Correct	<i>Reform, a slow and contested process, demands patience.</i>	Reform = noun (subject); slow, contested = adjectives; demands = verb.

MENTOR'S TIP

When a sentence confuses you, find the main verb first, then its subject. Everything else is description hanging off that backbone. Naming the verb instantly clarifies the rest of the sentence.

CSS TRAP

Collective nouns (committee, government, jury, team, public) are singular in formal Pakistani and British usage. Write the government has, not the government have, unless you are deliberately stressing the individual members.

3. Practice Set

Identify the error of part-of-speech or agreement, then correct it.

- Each of the provinces have its own assembly.
- The reforms were implemented quick and without consultation.
- Neither of the proposals are practical in the current fiscal climate.
- The committee have postponed their decision until next week.
- He spoke confident about the success of the policy.
- The data clearly shows that literacy have improved.
- Every officer and every clerk were required to attend.
- The judgement was a real surprising to the legal community.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. Each of the provinces has its own assembly. (Each is singular.)
2. The reforms were implemented quickly and without consultation. (Adverb modifies the verb.)
3. Neither of the proposals is practical in the current fiscal climate. (Neither is singular.)
4. The committee has postponed its decision until next week. (Collective noun = singular.)
5. He spoke confidently about the success of the policy. (Adverb modifies spoke.)
6. The data clearly shows that literacy has improved. (Literacy is singular.)
7. Every officer and every clerk was required to attend. (Every ... and every takes a singular verb.)
8. The judgement was a real surprise to the legal community. (Use the noun surprise, not the adjective.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A one-page parts-of-speech chart with two CSS-themed examples each, plus twenty corrected sentences with the rule named for every correction.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I name the function of a word, not merely its dictionary category?
- Can I keep each, every, either, and neither singular?
- Can I explain the difference between an adjective and an adverb without guessing?

Day 2 Sentence Structure and Clauses

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 2 OF 30

Goal: Command the four sentence types so your writing is grammatically sound, varied, and mature.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

CSS essays reward controlled complexity. A candidate who can combine ideas correctly writes mature introductions, sharp topic sentences, and analytical paragraphs without fragments or run-ons.

1. Learn the Rule

Clauses are the building blocks

A clause is a group of words with a subject and a verb. An independent clause can stand alone as a sentence. A dependent (subordinate) clause cannot; it needs an independent clause to lean on.

- *Independent: The policy failed.*
- *Dependent: because implementation remained weak (cannot stand alone)*

The four sentence types

Mastering these lets you control rhythm and emphasis instead of writing one flat sentence after another.

- *Simple (one independent clause): The policy failed.*
- *Compound (two independent clauses joined by and, but, or, so, etc.): The policy failed, but the rhetoric continued.*
- *Complex (one independent + one or more dependent): The policy failed because implementation remained weak.*
- *Compound-complex (two independent + at least one dependent): The policy failed because oversight was weak, and public trust collapsed.*

Three kinds of dependent clause

Knowing the type tells you how to punctuate and combine.

- *Noun clause (acts as a noun): What the country needs is reform.*
- *Adjective (relative) clause: The minister who signed the order resigned.*
- *Adverb clause: When the subsidy ended, prices rose.*

Avoid the two cardinal sins

A fragment is a dependent clause punctuated as a full sentence. A run-on (or comma splice) joins two independent clauses with no proper link. Both signal weak control.

- *Fragment: Because the institutions were weak.* → *Reform stalled because the institutions were weak.*

→ *Comma splice: The reform passed, it was never enforced.* → *The reform passed, but it was never enforced.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Simple	<i>The policy failed.</i>	One independent clause, one complete idea.
Complex	<i>The policy failed because implementation remained weak.</i>	Independent clause + adverb clause of reason.
Faulty	<i>Although the reform was popular. It failed in practice.</i>	First part is a fragment; join them: Although the reform was popular, it failed in practice.
Strong	<i>While laws exist, they remain unenforced, and citizens lose faith.</i>	Compound-complex: controlled complexity suited to analysis.

MENTOR'S TIP

Underline the main verb in every sentence before you decide its type. Then circle subordinators (because, although, while, if, since, whereas). This habit alone removes most fragment errors.

CSS TRAP

A long sentence is not automatically a mature sentence. If the reader loses the main clause, the sentence has failed. Read every long sentence aloud and check that one clear idea survives.

3. Practice Set

Label the type, or correct the fragment / comma splice.

1. The reform passed easily, it was never implemented.
2. Although Pakistan has abundant resources.
3. Institutions were weak, therefore reform stalled.
4. Combine: The subsidy ended. Prices rose sharply.
5. Because the judiciary acted independently, public confidence increased.
6. The policy was ambitious, the budget was inadequate, the result was failure.
7. Combine into one complex sentence: The committee met. It produced no recommendations.
8. What the economy needs are structural reforms.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. The reform passed easily, but it was never implemented. (Comma splice fixed with a conjunction.)
2. Although Pakistan has abundant resources, it struggles to convert them into growth. (Fragment

completed with an independent clause.)

3. Institutions were weak; therefore, reform stalled. (Therefore is not a conjunction; use a semicolon.)
4. When the subsidy ended, prices rose sharply. (Complex sentence; adverb clause of time.)
5. Correct as written complex sentence, adverb clause of reason first, comma after it.
6. The policy was ambitious, the budget was inadequate, and the result was failure. (Series of clauses needs a conjunction before the last item.)
7. The committee met but produced no recommendations. / Although the committee met, it produced no recommendations.
8. What the economy needs is structural reforms. (The noun clause What the economy needs is singular.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Twenty sentences analysed and labelled by type, plus ten short sentences combined into clean complex sentences.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I find the main clause in a long sentence?
- Can I avoid fragments after subordinators?
- Can I use complex sentences without burying the main point?

Day 3 Punctuation and Capitalization

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 3 OF 30

Goal: Use punctuation as a system of meaning, not decoration, so your sentences are clear and controlled.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Punctuation errors quietly damage strong ideas in précis, correction, and essay writing. Correct punctuation signals discipline; sloppy punctuation signals haste, even when the argument is good.

1. Learn the Rule

The comma four reliable uses

Most comma confusion disappears once you restrict commas to these jobs:

- After an introductory element: *Despite the reforms, growth stalled.*
- Between items in a list: *laws, institutions, and enforcement.*
- Before a coordinating conjunction joining two independent clauses: *The law passed, but it was ignored.*
- Around a non-essential insertion: *The minister, who had just arrived, declined to comment.*

The comma splice the most common error

Two independent clauses cannot be joined by a comma alone. Fix it with a period, a semicolon, or a comma plus a coordinating conjunction.

- Wrong: *The ministry announced reforms, they were not implemented.*
- Right: *The ministry announced reforms; they were not implemented.*
- Right: *The ministry announced reforms, but they were not implemented.*

Capitalization

Capitalise proper nouns, official titles when attached to a name, institutions, nationalities, named laws, and documents. Do not capitalise ordinary common nouns or general references.

- Capitalise: *the Supreme Court, the Constitution of Pakistan, the Election Commission, Prime Minister Khan.*
- Do not capitalise: *the court ruled, constitutional principles, the prime minister arrived (no name attached).*

End-stops and the period

The period marks finality and controls sentence boundaries. When two complete ideas crowd together without a link, a period is often the cleanest repair.

- Run-on: *The crisis deepened the government delayed.* → *The crisis deepened. The government delayed.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>Although the policy was popular it failed in practice.</i>	Add a comma after the introductory clause: Although the policy was popular, it failed in practice.
Incorrect	<i>The ministry announced reforms, they were not implemented.</i>	Comma splice. Use a semicolon, a period, or add but.
Incorrect	<i>The Prime minister addressed the Parliament about Constitutional reform.</i>	Prime Minister (title with name/role context), Parliament (proper), constitutional (adjective, lowercase).
Correct	<i>Three institutions failed: the bureaucracy, the police, and the courts.</i>	Colon introduces a list after a complete clause; serial comma before and.

MENTOR'S TIP

Before placing a comma between two ideas, test whether each side could stand alone as a sentence. If both can, a comma alone is not enough you need a semicolon, a period, or a conjunction.

CSS TRAP

Do not capitalise a word just because it feels important. Government, parliament, democracy, and constitution are lowercase as general nouns; they are capitalised only as part of a specific official name (the Government of Pakistan, the Constitution).

3. Practice Set

Repair the punctuation or capitalization error.

1. The reforms were ambitious however they lacked funding.
2. When the subsidy ended prices rose.
3. The Government announced a new Policy on Climate change.
4. Corruption is widespread, it undermines public trust.
5. The Court delivered its Judgement, citing the constitution.
6. Pakistan a federal state faces serious provincial tensions.
7. Education health and security all demand investment.
8. He asked whether the project had failed.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. The reforms were ambitious; however, they lacked funding. (However is a connector, not a conjunction.)
2. When the subsidy ended, prices rose. (Comma after the introductory clause.)

3. The government announced a new policy on climate change. (Common nouns are lowercase.)
4. Corruption is widespread, and it undermines public trust. / Corruption is widespread; it undermines public trust. (Fix the comma splice.)
5. The court delivered its judgement, citing the Constitution. (Court lowercase as a general reference; Constitution capitalised as a named document.)
6. Pakistan, a federal state, faces serious provincial tensions. (Commas around the non-essential appositive.)
7. Education, health, and security all demand investment. (Commas separate list items.)
8. Correct an indirect question ends with a period, not a question mark.

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A corrected paragraph plus a personal capitalization checklist of twenty proper nouns and official titles common in Pakistan affairs.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I spot a comma splice instantly?
- Can I explain why a comma follows an introductory clause?
- Can I avoid capitalising ordinary common nouns?

Day 4 Subject–Verb Agreement

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 4 OF 30

Goal: Make every verb agree with its true subject, even when distracting phrases sit in between.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Agreement errors are among the most common correction traps and they weaken essay credibility on the very first line. Examiners plant a phrase between subject and verb to see whether you can find the real subject.

1. Learn the Rule

Find the true subject

The verb agrees with the subject, never with a noun that merely sits nearby. Mentally cross out any phrase between the subject and the verb, then check agreement.

- *The quality of the roads is poor. (subject = quality, singular)*
- *The list of demands was rejected. (subject = list, not demands)*

Indefinite pronouns are singular

Each, every, either, neither, everyone, someone, anyone, no one, nobody take a singular verb always, in formal English.

- *Each of the ministers is responsible.*
- *Neither of the options is acceptable.*

Compound subjects

Two subjects joined by and are usually plural. With or / nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject.

- *The chairman and the secretary are present. (and = plural)*
- *Neither the chairman nor the members are present. (nearer subject = members, plural)*
- *Neither the members nor the chairman is present. (nearer subject = chairman, singular)*

Tricky nouns

Some nouns look plural but are treated as singular; others are collective. Learn the common CSS offenders.

- *Singular: news, politics, economics, mathematics, ethics (as a field).*
- *Usually singular in formal use: data (treated as a mass), media (increasingly singular, but data are / media are remain correct in strict usage).*
- *Collective (singular as one body): government, committee, jury, public.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
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Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>The quality of public services are declining.</i>	Subject is quality: is declining.
Incorrect	<i>Neither of the proposals are practical.</i>	Neither is singular: is practical.
Incorrect	<i>The number of unemployed youth are rising.</i>	The number is singular: is rising. (But a number of youths are rising would be plural.)
Correct	<i>Politics is a demanding profession.</i>	Politics as a field is singular.

MENTOR'S TIP

Two phrases decide most agreement questions: the number of (singular) and a number of (plural). The number of cases is rising; a number of cases are pending.

CSS TRAP

Phrases like along with, as well as, together with, and in addition to do NOT make a singular subject plural. The minister, along with his aides, was present not were.

3. Practice Set

Correct the agreement error and underline the true subject in your mind.

1. The list of approved candidates were published yesterday.
2. Each of the schools have received new funding.
3. The government, along with its allies, were criticised.
4. Neither the judges nor the lawyer were satisfied.
5. The number of pending cases are alarming.
6. Statistics on poverty shows a worrying trend.
7. Economics are central to the civil service examination.
8. A series of reforms have been announced.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The list of approved candidates was published yesterday. (Subject = list.)
2. Each of the schools has received new funding. (Each is singular.)
3. The government, along with its allies, was criticised. (Along with does not change the number.)
4. Neither the judges nor the lawyer was satisfied. (Verb agrees with the nearer subject, lawyer.)
5. The number of pending cases is alarming. (The number is singular.)
6. Statistics on poverty show a worrying trend. (Here statistics = figures, plural. As a field of study it would be singular.)
7. Economics is central to the civil service examination. (Economics as a discipline is singular.)
8. A series of reforms has been announced. (A series is singular.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A two-column correction sheet: original sentence, corrected sentence, and the true subject identified for each.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I find the subject when a phrase sits between it and the verb?
- Do I know when a compound subject is plural?
- Can I handle each, either, neither, the number of and a number of confidently?

Day 5 Verb Tense System and Sequence of Tenses

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 5 OF 30

Goal: Use tense to show time, sequence, continuity, completion, and present relevance with precision.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Précis and comprehension demand accurate tense control. Essay arguments rely on moving cleanly between past causes, present realities, and future consequences without random shifts.

1. Learn the Rule

The system, not twelve random forms

There are three times (past, present, future) and four aspects (simple, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous). Each tense is one time crossed with one aspect. Decide the meaning first, then the form follows.

- *Simple = fact or completed action: The government implemented the policy.*
- *Continuous = action in progress: The government is implementing the policy.*
- *Perfect = completed but relevant now / before another past point: The government has implemented the policy.*
- *Perfect continuous = ongoing duration up to a point: The government has been implementing the policy for two years.*

Present simple for general truths

Use the present simple for permanent facts, definitions, and habitual truths the natural tense of analysis and argument.

- *Corruption undermines institutional trust. (a general truth, present simple)*

Sequence of tenses

Within a sentence, keep tenses logically consistent. When the main verb is past, dependent verbs usually shift to the past as well unless you are stating a timeless truth.

- *He said that the economy was recovering. (past reporting → past)*
- *The scientist proved that water boils at 100°C. (timeless fact stays present)*

Do not shift tense without reason

The most common essay flaw is drifting between past and present inside one paragraph. Choose a base tense for the paragraph and shift only when meaning requires it.

- *Wrong: The committee submitted its report and recommends reforms.*
- *Right: The committee submitted its report and recommended reforms.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>The committee submitted its report and recommends reforms.</i>	Keep the sequence: submitted ... recommended.
Better	<i>Since 2010, successive governments have promised reform.</i>	Present perfect links a past start to present relevance.
Incorrect	<i>By the time the aid arrived, the crisis worsened.</i>	Earlier past action needs the past perfect: had worsened.
Correct	<i>The report shows that poverty rose sharply after the floods.</i>	Present (shows) for the report's standing claim; past (rose) for the completed event.

MENTOR'S TIP

Draw a quick mental timeline for any sentence with two past actions. The earlier action takes the past perfect (had + participle); the later action takes the simple past. This single move fixes most sequence errors.

CSS TRAP

Do not use the present perfect with a finished past time marker. Write Pakistan gained independence in 1947, not has gained independence in 1947. The perfect cannot sit with a specific past date.

3. Practice Set

Correct the tense or sequence error.

1. The minister announces the budget last week.
2. By the time reforms began, the economy already collapsed.
3. He argued that corruption is the root cause and undermined growth.
4. Since 2015, the government implemented several austerity measures.
5. When the report was published, the public reacts angrily.
6. Water boiled at 100 degrees Celsius, the teacher explained.
7. The country has gained independence in 1947.
8. After the policy failed, the government revises its strategy.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The minister announced the budget last week. (Finished past time marker → simple past.)
2. By the time reforms began, the economy had already collapsed. (Earlier past → past perfect.)
3. He argued that corruption was the root cause and undermined growth. (Consistent past sequence.)
4. Since 2015, the government has implemented several austerity measures. (Since + present perfect)

perfect.)

5. When the report was published, the public reacted angrily. (Both past.)
6. Water boils at 100 degrees Celsius, the teacher explained. (Timeless truth stays present even after a past reporting verb.)
7. The country gained independence in 1947. (Specific past date → simple past.)
8. After the policy failed, the government revised its strategy. (Consistent past.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A tense timeline chart plus twenty corrected sentences, each with a one-line note explaining why that tense is required.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I explain why a tense is used, not just name it?
- Can I avoid shifting from past to present without reason?
- Can I use the past perfect for the earlier of two past actions?

Day 6 Conditionals and the Subjunctive Mood

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 6 OF 30

Goal: Use conditional structures to express facts, likely results, hypotheticals, regrets, and policy consequences.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Conditionals are powerful in essays because they model consequence: if governance improves, service delivery improves. Used well, they make analysis sound measured and logical rather than asserted.

1. Learn the Rule

The four conditionals

Each type matches a different relationship between condition and result. Learn the verb pattern with the meaning attached.

- *Zero (general truth): If institutions are weak, corruption spreads. (if + present, present)*
- *First (likely future): If the government invests in education, literacy will improve. (if + present, will + base)*
- *Second (unlikely / hypothetical present): If the state collected taxes efficiently, it would not borrow. (if + past, would + base)*
- *Third (impossible past): If the policy had been implemented honestly, trust would have increased. (if + past perfect, would have + participle)*

Mixed conditionals

A past condition can have a present result, or a present condition a past result. Match each half to its own time.

- *If the reforms had succeeded, the country would be prosperous today. (past condition, present result)*

The subjunctive

Formal English keeps the subjunctive in two places: were for hypotheticals, and the base verb after demand, require, suggest, recommend, essential, important.

- *If I were the policymaker, I would prioritise education. (not was)*
- *It is essential that he be present. The committee recommended that the rule be amended. (base verb, no -s)*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>If the government would invest in education, literacy will improve.</i>	No would in the if-clause: If the government invests ..., literacy will

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
		improve.
Formal	<i>If the policy had been implemented honestly, public trust would have increased.</i>	Third conditional: unreal past condition, unreal past result.
Incorrect	<i>It is essential that every officer attends the briefing.</i>	Subjunctive after essential that: ... that every officer attend.
Correct	<i>If I were responsible for the budget, I would cut non-development spending.</i>	Were is the formal subjunctive for a hypothetical.

MENTOR'S TIP

Never put would in the if-clause of a standard conditional. The if-clause sets the condition; would belongs in the result clause. If ... invests, ... would improve not if ... would invest.

CSS TRAP

After it is essential / important / vital that, and after demand / require / suggest / recommend that, use the bare base verb: ... that the rule be changed, ... that he submit the report not is changed or submits.

3. Practice Set

Correct the conditional or subjunctive error.

1. If the government would reduce tariffs, exports will rise.
2. If institutions are strong, corruption spreads less. (Identify the type and confirm.)
3. It is important that the minister attends the session.
4. If the floods had not occurred, the economy will have grown.
5. If I was the chief secretary, I would decentralise authority.
6. The committee recommended that the policy is revised.
7. If literacy improves, the country would prosper.
8. Had the warnings been heeded, the disaster could have been avoided. (Confirm whether correct.)

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. If the government reduced tariffs, exports would rise. (Second conditional hypothetical.) Or, if likely: If the government reduces tariffs, exports will rise.
2. Correct zero conditional expressing a general truth.
3. It is important that the minister attend the session. (Subjunctive base verb.)
4. If the floods had not occurred, the economy would have grown. (Third conditional.)
5. If I were the chief secretary, I would decentralise authority. (Subjunctive were.)
6. The committee recommended that the policy be revised. (Subjunctive after recommended that.)

7. If literacy improves, the country will prosper. (First conditional keep tenses matched.) Or fully hypothetical: If literacy improved, the country would prosper.
8. Correct inverted third conditional (Had ... been heeded = If ... had been heeded).

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A conditional sentence bank of twenty-five original CSS-themed examples, labelled by type.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I match each conditional type to its intended meaning?
- Can I keep would out of ordinary if-clauses?
- Can I use were and the base-verb subjunctive in formal statements?

Day 7 Reported (Indirect) Speech

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 7 OF 30

Goal: Convert direct speech into indirect speech accurately, preserving meaning, tense, and reference.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Reported speech is a direct correction topic and a constant essay tool when you summarise officials, scholars, reports, or court judgements without quoting them word for word.

1. Learn the Rule

Backshift the tense

When the reporting verb is past (said, stated, argued), the reported verb usually shifts one step back in time.

- *present* → *past*: *is* → *was*; *reforms* → *reformed*
- *will* → *would*; *can* → *could*; *may* → *might*; *must* → *had to*
- *present perfect* / *past* → *past perfect*: *has done* / *did* → *had done*

Shift pronouns, time, and place

The viewpoint moves from speaker to reporter, so references change.

- *now* → *then*; *today* → *that day*; *tomorrow* → *the following day*; *yesterday* → *the previous day*
- *here* → *there*; *this* → *that*; *these* → *those*

Questions become statements

Reported questions take statement word order (subject before verb) and no question mark. Use *if* / *whether* for yes-no questions.

- *He asked, 'Why did the project fail?'* → *He asked why the project had failed.*
- *She asked, 'Is the report ready?'* → *She asked whether the report was ready.*

Commands, requests, and precise reporting verbs

Use *to* + verb for orders and requests, and choose a reporting verb that captures tone. *Said* is rarely the strongest choice.

- *'Submit the file.'* → *He ordered them to submit the file.*
- *Choose: stated, argued, claimed, warned, advised, urged, conceded, denied.*

When NOT to backshift

If the statement is still true or a general truth, you may keep the present tense.

- *The scientist said that water boils at 100°C.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Direct	<i>The minister said, 'We will implement the policy tomorrow.'</i>	Indirect: The minister said that they would implement the policy the following day.
Question	<i>He asked, 'Why did the project fail?'</i>	Indirect: He asked why the project had failed.
Command	<i>The judge said, 'Submit the documents by Friday.'</i>	Indirect: The judge directed them to submit the documents by Friday.
No shift	<i>The teacher said, 'The earth revolves around the sun.'</i>	Indirect: The teacher said that the earth revolves around the sun. (general truth)

MENTOR'S TIP

Pick the reporting verb before you backshift. Argued, warned, conceded, and urged carry analysis that said does not and a precise reporting verb is worth marks in both correction and essay writing.

CSS TRAP

In reported questions, do not keep question word order and do not keep the question mark. He asked why the project had failed not He asked why did the project fail?

3. Practice Set

Convert to indirect speech (or correct the faulty conversion).

1. The PM said, 'We are facing a severe economic crisis.'
2. She asked, 'Have you completed the report?'
3. He said, 'I will resign tomorrow.'
4. The officer asked why did the file get delayed.
5. 'Reduce expenditure immediately,' the secretary ordered.
6. The economist said, 'Inflation is rising.'
7. He asked, 'Where is the committee meeting?'
8. The judge said, 'The accused is guilty.'

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The PM said that they were facing a severe economic crisis.
2. She asked whether I had completed the report.
3. He said that he would resign the following day.
4. The officer asked why the file had been delayed. (Statement word order; no question mark.)
5. The secretary ordered them to reduce expenditure immediately.
6. The economist said that inflation was rising.
7. He asked where the committee was meeting.

8. The judge said that the accused was guilty.

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Twenty-five quotations converted to indirect speech, with the changed words marked, and a short list of reporting verbs grouped by tone.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I convert questions into statement word order?
- Can I choose reporting verbs more precise than said?
- Can I keep pronoun and time references clear after the shift?

Day 8 Phase 1 Review Test

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATIONS OF ACCURACY • DAY 8 OF 30

Goal: Test the foundation topics under time pressure and identify the errors that must be removed before Phase 2.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

This review simulates the mental pressure of the correction section and the sentence discipline essay writing demands. The point is not the score it is the diagnosis.

1. Learn the Rule

What is being tested

Everything from Days 1–7 at once: parts of speech, clauses, punctuation, agreement, tense and sequence, conditionals, and reported speech now mixed, the way the examiner mixes them.

How to sit a review test

Work like it is the exam, then learn like it is a classroom.

- Set a timer (40 minutes for the items below) and use no notes.
- Mark uncertain answers with a dot instead of guessing blindly you will revisit them.
- After checking, write the rule for every error, not just the correction.
- Rewrite one weak paragraph in fully correct grammar.

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Habit	<i>Wrong: neither of them are ready.</i>	Rule note: neither is singular → is ready.
Habit	<i>Wrong: if he will study, he will pass.</i>	Rule note: first conditional uses present simple after if.
Habit	<i>Wrong: he asked why did the policy fail.</i>	Rule note: reported questions take statement order → why the policy had failed.

MENTOR'S TIP

After this test, do not move to Phase 2 until you can name from memory your three most frequent error types. Those three are your personal syllabus for the rest of the course.

3. Practice Set

Mixed Phase 1 review. Correct each sentence and name the rule you applied.

1. Each of the departments have submitted their budget.

2. Although the reform was overdue. The government delayed it.
3. The minister said that he will resign the next day.
4. By the time aid arrived, thousands already died.
5. The list of demands were rejected by the committee.
6. If the state would tax fairly, the deficit will shrink.
7. The Court ruled that the Policy was unconstitutional.
8. Corruption is widespread, it erodes public confidence.
9. She asked whether had the report been finalised.
10. Neither the governor nor the ministers was informed.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. Each of the departments has submitted its budget. (Agreement each is singular.)
2. Although the reform was overdue, the government delayed it. (Fragment joined to the main clause.)
3. The minister said that he would resign the following day. (Reported speech backshift will → would, next → following.)
4. By the time aid arrived, thousands had already died. (Sequence earlier past takes past perfect.)
5. The list of demands was rejected by the committee. (Agreement subject is list.)
6. If the state taxed fairly, the deficit would shrink. (Second conditional.) Or: If the state taxes fairly, the deficit will shrink.
7. The court ruled that the policy was unconstitutional. (Capitalization general nouns lowercase.)
8. Corruption is widespread, and it erodes public confidence. (Comma splice fixed.)
9. She asked whether the report had been finalised. (Reported question statement word order.)
10. Neither the governor nor the ministers were informed. (Verb agrees with the nearer subject, ministers.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A scored review sheet, one 150-word paragraph rewritten in correct grammar, and a ranked list of your top five error types.

Self-check before you stop:

- Which rule failed most often under pressure?
- Which errors appeared only because of the timer?
- Can I explain every correction without opening my notes?

PHASE 2Days 9–16

Intermediate Structure and Cohesion

*Move from correct sentences to controlled, connected writing
variety, precision, and smooth flow.*

Day 9 Active Voice, Passive Voice, and Causatives

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 9 OF 30

Goal: Choose active or passive voice deliberately, according to emphasis, formality, and clarity.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Passive voice is common in formal essays and reports, but overuse drains energy from an argument. CSS writing needs balance: active for responsibility, passive for objectivity.

1. Learn the Rule

How the two voices differ

In the active voice, the subject performs the action. In the passive voice, the subject receives it. Passive is formed with a form of be + the past participle.

- *Active: The court rejected the petition.*
- *Passive: The petition was rejected (by the court).*

When passive is the right choice

Prefer passive when the action or result matters more than the doer, when the doer is unknown or unimportant, or when you want an impersonal, formal tone.

- *The suspect was arrested last night. (the arrest matters more than who made it)*
- *Mistakes were made. (doer deliberately hidden use sparingly and honestly)*

When active is stronger

Keep the active voice when responsibility should stay visible and when you want directness and force most argument sentences.

- *Weak: It was decided by the committee that the project would be cancelled.*
- *Strong: The committee cancelled the project.*

Causatives

Causative structures show that the subject made someone else do something. Learn three patterns.

- *have someone do something: The minister had his staff prepare the report.*
- *get someone to do something: The minister got his staff to prepare the report.*
- *have / get something done: The minister had the report prepared.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Active	<i>The court rejected the petition.</i>	Passive: The petition was rejected by the court.
Weak	<i>It was felt by the committee that reform was</i>	Active is cleaner: The committee felt that

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>necessary.</i>	reform was necessary.
Causative	<i>The department had the report revised.</i>	The department caused someone else to revise the report.
Correct	<i>The accused was sentenced to ten years.</i>	Agentless passive the doer (the court) is obvious and need not be named.

MENTOR'S TIP

A simple test: if you can add the phrase *by zombies* after the verb and it still fits grammatically, the sentence is passive (the report was rejected by zombies). Then ask whether passive truly serves your meaning if not, switch to active.

CSS TRAP

Examiners punish the empty passive that hides the actor in argument writing. It is believed that, it was decided that, and steps were taken weaken analysis. Name the actor unless there is a real reason to conceal it.

3. Practice Set

Convert the voice (or fix the awkward passive). State why your version is better.

1. The committee approved the proposal. (Make passive.)
2. It was decided by the government to raise taxes. (Improve.)
3. Mistakes in the audit were made by the junior staff. (Make active.)
4. The minister got the file to be reviewed by his secretary. (Correct the causative.)
5. The verdict was announced. (Decide whether the agentless passive is acceptable.)
6. The police arrested twelve suspects. (Make passive and judge if useful.)
7. Reforms have been promised by every government since 1990. (Make active.)
8. The school had its roof repaired. (Identify the structure.)

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The proposal was approved by the committee. (Useful if the proposal is the topic.)
2. The government decided to raise taxes. (Active is shorter and assigns responsibility.)
3. The junior staff made mistakes in the audit. (Active names the actor directly.)
4. The minister had his secretary review the file. / had the file reviewed. (Causative: have + person + base verb.)
5. Acceptable the doer (court/jury) is obvious, so the agentless passive works.
6. Twelve suspects were arrested by the police. (Useful only if the suspects are the focus; otherwise keep active.)

7. Every government since 1990 has promised reforms. (Active assigns clear responsibility.)
8. Causative: have something done the school caused the roof to be repaired.

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A voice-conversion worksheet of twenty sentences, each marked with a one-line reason for the voice chosen, plus ten original causative sentences.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I form the passive in all major tenses?
- Can I decide when passive genuinely improves tone?
- Can I use have / get + done without awkward phrasing?

Day 10 Verbs: Gerunds, Participles, and Infinitives

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 10 OF 30

Goal: Recognise and use verb-based forms that work as nouns, adjectives, and complements.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Verbals let you build concise, mature sentences and combine ideas elegantly. They also appear constantly in correction questions, especially the dangling participle.

1. Learn the Rule

Gerunds act as nouns

A gerund is the -ing form used as a noun. It can be a subject, an object, or follow a preposition.

- *Reforming the bureaucracy requires political will. (subject)*
- *The government delayed implementing the policy. (object)*
- *The minister insisted on reviewing the file. (after a preposition)*

Participles act as adjectives

Present participles (-ing) and past participles (-ed / -en) describe nouns and open descriptive phrases. The participle must logically attach to the right noun.

- *The rising prices alarmed consumers. (present participle as adjective)*
- *Shaken by the verdict, the official resigned. (past participle phrase modifying official)*

Infinitives (to + base verb)

Infinitives follow many verbs and adjectives, and can express purpose. Learn which verbs take an infinitive and which take a gerund.

- *Gerund verbs: enjoy, avoid, consider, suggest, deny, recommend (enjoy reading).*
- *Infinitive verbs: decide, need, agree, hope, refuse, attempt (decide to act).*
- *Purpose: The state raised taxes to reduce the deficit.*

The dangling participle (high-yield trap)

When a sentence opens with a participial phrase, the noun immediately after the comma must be the doer of that phrase. If it is not, the modifier dangles.

- *Wrong: Walking into the hall, the speech impressed the audience. (the speech was not walking)*
- *Right: Walking into the hall, the audience was impressed by the speech. / As the speaker walked into the hall, the audience was impressed.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Gerund	<i>Improving governance requires institutional</i>	Improving is a noun-like subject.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>reform.</i>	
Faulty	<i>Walking into the hall, the speech impressed the audience.</i>	Dangling participle. The audience walked, not the speech.
Incorrect	<i>The government avoided to address the crisis.</i>	Avoid takes a gerund: avoided addressing the crisis.
Correct	<i>Having reviewed the evidence, the judge dismissed the case.</i>	Perfect participle with a clear, correct subject.

MENTOR'S TIP

Build a verb-pattern page in your notebook with two columns: verbs followed by a gerund and verbs followed by an infinitive. Memorising even twenty pairs eliminates a whole class of correction errors.

CSS TRAP

After a leading participial phrase, check the very next word. If it is not the thing performing the action, rewrite. This single habit catches almost every dangling-modifier question on the paper.

3. Practice Set

Correct the verbal error.

1. The committee recommended to postpone the meeting.
2. After reviewing the budget, the decision was made to cut spending.
3. He is interested in to study public policy.
4. Reducing poverty are the main goal of the programme.
5. The minister denied to have any knowledge of the deal.
6. Exhausted by the campaign, the rally was cancelled by the leader.
7. She suggested to increase the education budget.
8. To improving literacy, the government built new schools.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The committee recommended postponing the meeting. (Recommend + gerund.)
2. After reviewing the budget, the government decided to cut spending. (The doer must follow the phrase.)
3. He is interested in studying public policy. (After a preposition → gerund.)
4. Reducing poverty is the main goal of the programme. (Gerund subject is singular.)
5. The minister denied having any knowledge of the deal. (Deny + gerund.)
6. Exhausted by the campaign, the leader cancelled the rally. (The leader was exhausted, not the rally.)

7. She suggested increasing the education budget. (Suggest + gerund.)
8. To improve literacy, the government built new schools. (Infinitive of purpose, not to + -ing.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A verb-pattern list (gerund vs. infinitive) plus thirty verbals classified by function and five dangling modifiers corrected.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I tell a gerund from a participle by its function?
- Can I use the right verb pattern (enjoy doing vs. agree to do)?
- Can I catch a dangling participle by checking the word after the comma?

Day 11 Modifiers: Dangling and Misplaced

PHASE 2 • STRUCTURE & COHESION • DAY 11 OF 30

Goal: Place every descriptive word and phrase so the sentence says exactly what you intend.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Misplaced modifiers make formal writing unintentionally comic or ambiguous. Under exam pressure, precision of placement separates polished candidates from careless ones.

1. Learn the Rule

The placement principle

A modifier attaches to the nearest available word. So place it as close as possible to the word it describes. Distance creates ambiguity.

- *Ambiguous:* The officer reported the theft to the inspector in his office. (whose office?)
- *Clear:* In his office, the officer reported the theft to the inspector.

Misplaced modifiers

A misplaced modifier sits next to the wrong word and changes the meaning.

- *Wrong:* The minister announced the plan wearing a grey suit. (the plan was not wearing a suit)
- *Right:* Wearing a grey suit, the minister announced the plan.

Limiting words: only, almost, nearly, merely, even, just

These words modify whatever immediately follows them. Move only and the meaning shifts.

- *The minister only promised reforms.* (he promised but did nothing more)
- *The minister promised only reforms.* (reforms and nothing else)
- *Only the minister promised reforms.* (no one else did)

Squinting modifiers

A squinting modifier can point backward or forward, leaving the reader unsure. Reposition it so it points one way.

- *Squinting:* Officials who lie often lose public trust. (lie often, or often lose?)
- *Fixed:* Officials who often lie lose public trust. / Officials who lie often lose public trust → reword.

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>The minister only promised reforms in the speech.</i>	If he made no other commitment, place only carefully: promised only reforms.
Dangling	<i>After reviewing the evidence, the verdict was announced.</i>	Who reviewed it? After reviewing the evidence, the judge announced the verdict.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Misplaced	<i>She almost donated all her savings to the fund.</i>	Almost donated implies she did not donate. Better: She donated almost all her savings.
Correct	<i>Driving through the flood zone, the team documented the damage.</i>	The team did the driving modifier attaches correctly.

MENTOR'S TIP

For every introductory phrase, ask one question: who or what is doing this? The answer must be the subject that follows the comma. If it is not, the modifier dangles and the sentence must be rewritten.

CSS TRAP

Only is the single most misplaced word in CSS scripts. Decide exactly what only limits, then put it directly in front of that word. Most students drop it carelessly before the verb and change their own meaning.

3. Practice Set

Correct the misplaced or dangling modifier (or reposition only).

1. Running late, the bus was missed by the commuters.
2. The candidate only failed the interview, not the written exam. (Confirm placement.)
3. He served tea to the guests in plastic cups.
4. Hoping for promotion, the report was submitted early by the officer.
5. The policy nearly helped a million families.
6. To understand the crisis, accurate data is essential.
7. She almost spent the entire budget on salaries.
8. Covered in dust, the archivist found the missing file.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. Running late, the commuters missed the bus. (The commuters were late.)
2. The candidate failed only the interview, not the written exam. (Only limits the interview.)
3. He served tea in plastic cups to the guests. (The tea was in cups, not the guests.)
4. Hoping for promotion, the officer submitted the report early. (The officer hoped.)
5. The policy helped nearly a million families. (Nearly limits the number.)
6. To understand the crisis, we need accurate data. (Supply a doer for the infinitive phrase.)
7. She spent almost the entire budget on salaries. (Almost limits the amount.)
8. Covered in dust, the missing file was found by the archivist. / The archivist found the dust-covered missing file. (The file was dusty, not the archivist.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Twenty corrected modifier errors, each annotated with the intended meaning, plus ten sentences showing only in different positions.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I identify what each modifier is meant to describe?
- Can I place only, almost, and merely precisely?
- Can I avoid introductory phrases that have no logical doer?

Day 12 Articles and Determiners

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 12 OF 30

Goal: Use a, an, the, the zero article, and determiners with accuracy in formal English.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Article errors are the single most frequent flaw in Pakistani-English writing, and they appear naturally throughout précis, essay, and correction tasks. Fixing them instantly raises the polish of a script.

1. Learn the Rule

Two questions decide most articles

Before choosing an article, ask: (1) Is the noun countable or uncountable? (2) Is it specific or general? Those two answers point to the right choice.

- *a / an: one non-specific countable noun a policy, an institution.*
- *the: specific, unique, or already-mentioned the Constitution, the policy we discussed.*
- *zero article: general plural or uncountable nouns institutions matter; corruption is harmful.*

Abstract nouns usually take no article

When you speak of a concept in general, use no article. Add the only when you specify a particular instance.

- *General: Democracy depends on accountability.*
- *Specific: The democracy established after 1973 remained fragile.*

The with names the patterns

Some proper nouns take the; many do not. Learn the families.

- *Use the: rivers (the Indus), seas (the Arabian Sea), groups of states (the United States), institutions (the Senate), newspapers (the Dawn commonly Dawn), titles with of (the President of Pakistan).*
- *No the: single countries (Pakistan), continents (Asia), most cities (Lahore), languages (Urdu).*

Determiners

Determiners quantify or specify nouns; match them to countability. Use fewer / many / number for countables and less / much / amount for uncountables.

- *much information, many reports; less corruption, fewer cases.*
- *this report, these reports; that policy, those policies.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Incorrect	<i>The democracy is essential for accountability.</i>	General abstract noun: Democracy is essential for accountability.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Correct	<i>The democracy established after the crisis remained fragile.</i>	Specific instance, so the is correct.
Incorrect	<i>He is honest man with strong principles.</i>	Singular countable needs an article: an honest man.
Incorrect	<i>Government must reduce the poverty.</i>	The government (specific); reduce poverty (general abstract, no article).

MENTOR'S TIP

When you write an abstract noun (justice, poverty, education, democracy, corruption) ask whether you mean it in general. If yes, drop the article. Removing unnecessary the before abstract nouns alone will fix many of your sentences.

CSS TRAP

Use an, not a, before a vowel sound, not just a vowel letter: an honest officer (silent h), a university (yoo- sound), an MNA (em- sound), a one-day strike (wun- sound). Judge by sound, never by spelling.

3. Practice Set

Insert the correct article (a / an / the /) or fix the determiner.

- ___ corruption remains ___ biggest obstacle to development.
- He was ___ honest officer admired by ___ public.
- Government should invest in ___ education and ___ health.
- There were less applicants this year than last year.
- ___ Constitution of Pakistan guarantees fundamental rights.
- She gave many advice to the new recruits.
- Pakistan is ___ South Asian country with ___ rich history.
- The amount of voters increased in the recent election.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

- Corruption remains the biggest obstacle to development. (general abstract; the with superlative.)
- He was an honest officer admired by the public. (an before the vowel sound; the public is specific.)
- Government should invest in education and health. (general abstract nouns, no article; ideally the government.)
- There were fewer applicants this year than last year. (countable → fewer.)
- The Constitution of Pakistan guarantees fundamental rights. (specific named document.)
- She gave much advice to the new recruits. (advice is uncountable → much.)

7. Pakistan is a South Asian country with a rich history. (a + singular countable; a before history here.)
8. The number of voters increased in the recent election. (voters are countable → number, not amount.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

An article rule-sheet plus thirty corrected article/determiner blanks drawn from current-affairs sentences.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I tell countable from uncountable nouns?
- Can I distinguish general meaning from specific reference?
- Can I choose a vs. an by sound, and fewer vs. less correctly?

Day 13 Prepositions and Phrasal Verbs

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 13 OF 30

Goal: Use prepositions idiomatically and handle phrasal verbs without slipping into informality.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Prepositions are the single most common error for non-native writers, and examiners notice them instantly. A wrong preposition can make an otherwise strong sentence look careless.

1. Learn the Rule

Prepositions follow idiom, not logic

There is rarely a rule that explains why one preposition is correct and another wrong it is fixed usage. The only reliable method is to learn the common collocations and read widely.

- *Correct: depend on, consist of, capable of, comply with, deprived of*
- *Wrong: depend from, consist in (rare/archaic), capable to, comply to, deprived from*

Verbs that change meaning with the preposition

Some verbs shift sense entirely depending on the preposition. Choose deliberately.

- *agree with a person; agree to a proposal; agree on a plan*
- *result in an outcome; result from a cause*

Phrasal verbs and register

A phrasal verb is a verb plus a particle that together carry one meaning (carry out, bring about). Many are perfectly formal, but each usually has a single-word equivalent that reads more academically.

- *carry out = conduct; bring about = cause; put off = postpone*
- *look into = investigate; cut down on = reduce*

Keep prepositions parallel in pairs

When two verbs share an object, make sure both take the correct preposition; do not let one verb borrow the wrong one.

- *Wrong: He was interested and good at mathematics.*
- *Right: He was interested in and good at mathematics.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wrong	<i>The policy resulted into chaos.</i>	result in, not result into: The policy resulted in chaos.
Formal	<i>The commission will look into the matter.</i>	More academic: The commission will investigate the matter.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Correct	<i>The province is rich in mineral resources.</i>	rich in is the fixed collocation.
Faulty	<i>He is married with a doctor.</i>	married to a person; married with is a different (and wrong) sense here.

MENTOR'S TIP

Keep a personal preposition log. Every time a correction surprises you (comply with, not comply to), write the whole phrase, not just the word. You remember collocations as chunks, never as isolated prepositions.

CSS TRAP

Do not strand a casual phrasal verb in a formal essay where a single verb is sharper. Find out becomes ascertain; get rid of becomes eliminate. Formality is about precision, not stiffness but in CSS writing, the academic register usually wins.

3. Practice Set

Correct the preposition or replace the phrasal verb with a more formal single verb, as appropriate.

1. The report consists in three chapters.
2. The government must comply to international law.
3. Economic growth depends from political stability.
4. The committee will look into the allegations. (Make more formal.)
5. She is capable to lead the team.
6. We must cut down on wasteful expenditure. (Make more formal.)
7. He was accused for corruption.
8. The crisis resulted into mass unemployment.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The report consists of three chapters. (consist of is fixed.)
2. The government must comply with international law. (comply with.)
3. Economic growth depends on political stability. (depend on.)
4. The committee will investigate the allegations. (single formal verb.)
5. She is capable of leading the team. (capable of + gerund.)
6. We must reduce wasteful expenditure. (reduce is more formal.)
7. He was accused of corruption. (accused of.)
8. The crisis resulted in mass unemployment. (result in.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A two-column collocation bank: thirty fixed verb + preposition pairs, and ten phrasal verbs with their formal single-word equivalents.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I learn prepositions as part of whole phrases?
- Can I match each common phrasal verb to a formal synonym?
- Do I check both verbs when two share one object?

Day 14 Advanced Punctuation: Colons, Semicolons, and Dashes

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 14 OF 30

Goal: Use the colon, semicolon, and dash with confidence to control rhythm and signal relationships between ideas.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Day 3 fixed the basics. Now you learn the marks that separate competent writing from sophisticated writing. Used correctly, they show an examiner that you control structure, not just grammar.

1. Learn the Rule

The semicolon joins two independent clauses

Use a semicolon to link two complete sentences whose ideas are closely related, where a full stop would feel too final and a comma would be a splice.

- *Correct: The economy is recovering; unemployment, however, remains high.*
- *Wrong (comma splice): The economy is recovering, unemployment remains high.*

The semicolon separates items in a complex list

When list items themselves contain commas, use semicolons to keep the groupings clear.

- *The delegation included officers from Lahore, Punjab; Karachi, Sindh; and Quetta, Balochistan.*

The colon introduces and points forward

Use a colon after a complete statement to introduce a list, an explanation, or an example. What precedes the colon must be a full sentence.

- *Correct: Three pillars sustain democracy: representation, accountability, and the rule of law.*
- *Wrong: The pillars are: representation, accountability, the rule of law.*

The dash adds emphasis or interruption

A pair of dashes sets off a dramatic or parenthetical insertion; a single dash adds a punchy afterthought. Use sparingly in formal prose.

- *The reform long delayed and bitterly contested finally passed.*
- *Only one thing can save the institution now: genuine accountability.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Correct	<i>The verdict was clear; the reasoning behind it was not.</i>	Semicolon links two related independent clauses.
Wrong	<i>The cabinet approved three measures: which</i>	A colon must be followed by what it

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>were controversial.</i>	introduces, not a relative clause.
Strong	<i>Reform requires one thing above all: political will.</i>	Colon points forward to a deliberate, emphatic noun phrase.
Formal	<i>The report named three cities: Lahore, Punjab; Karachi, Sindh; and Peshawar, KP.</i>	Semicolons separate internally punctuated list items.

MENTOR'S TIP

Read your sentence aloud at the semicolon. If both halves could each stand alone as a sentence, the semicolon is correct. If one half cannot stand alone, you need a comma or a colon instead.

CSS TRAP

Never put a colon after a verb or a preposition. The areas are: x, y, z is wrong because the areas are is not a complete statement. Either drop the colon or complete the clause: There are three areas: x, y, and z.

3. Practice Set

Insert or correct the colon, semicolon, or dash. Some sentences need only one change.

1. The plan failed for one reason, it was never funded.
2. We must address three sectors energy, water, and agriculture.
3. The minister resigned, his deputy took charge immediately.
4. The committee included delegates from Lahore, Karachi, and Quetta and three observers.
5. There is only one solution, transparency.
6. The bill was passed however the rules were not framed for a year.
7. He had every advantage, wealth, education, and connections, yet he failed.
8. The report covered: governance, economy, and security.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The plan failed for one reason: it was never funded. (Colon introduces the explanation.)
2. We must address three sectors: energy, water, and agriculture. (Colon after a complete clause.)
3. The minister resigned; his deputy took charge immediately. (Semicolon links two independent clauses.)
4. ...from Lahore, Karachi, and Quetta; and three observers. (Semicolon clarifies the higher-level grouping.)
5. There is only one solution: transparency. (Colon points forward emphatically.)
6. The bill was passed; however, the rules were not framed for a year. (Semicolon before the conjunctive adverb.)

7. He had every advantage wealth, education, and connections yet he failed. (Dashes set off the emphatic list.)
8. The report covered governance, economy, and security. (Delete the colon; covered cannot precede a colon.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A punctuation showcase: five original sentences each for the colon, the semicolon, and the dash, drawn from current-affairs material.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I tell a comma splice from a correct semicolon?
- Do I always put a complete clause before a colon?
- Do I use dashes for emphasis without overusing them?

Day 15 Parallel Structure

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 15 OF 30

Goal: Keep items in a series, a comparison, or a paired construction in the same grammatical form.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Faulty parallelism is one of the most common reasons good ideas read awkwardly. Parallel structure makes lists elegant, comparisons clean, and whole paragraphs feel controlled exactly the polish examiners reward.

1. Learn the Rule

Items in a series must match

Every element joined by and or or should be the same part of speech or the same grammatical form all nouns, all gerunds, or all infinitives.

- *Wrong: The job requires honesty, patience, and to work hard.*
- *Right: The job requires honesty, patience, and hard work.*

Verbs in a series must share the same form

When a subject governs several verbs, keep their tense and form consistent.

- *Wrong: The reform reduced corruption, improved services, and was increasing trust.*
- *Right: The reform reduced corruption, improved services, and increased trust.*

Correlative conjunctions demand parallel halves

With not only ... but also, either ... or, neither ... nor, and both ... and, the structure after each half must mirror the other.

- *Wrong: She is not only intelligent but also works hard.*
- *Right: She is not only intelligent but also hardworking.*

Keep comparisons parallel

Both sides of a comparison with than or as must be grammatically comparable.

- *Wrong: Reforming the system is harder than to maintain it.*
- *Right: Reforming the system is harder than maintaining it.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Faulty	<i>The policy aims to reduce waste, improving efficiency, and cut costs.</i>	Mixed forms: ...aims to reduce waste, improve efficiency, and cut costs.
Parallel	<i>We must govern wisely, spend carefully, and plan ahead.</i>	Three matched verb phrases clean and rhythmic.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wrong	<i>He is responsible both for policy and implementing it.</i>	...responsible both for policy and for implementation.
Strong	<i>The state failed not in vision but in execution.</i>	not ... but balances two matching prepositional phrases.

MENTOR'S TIP

Stack the list vertically in your mind: line up each item under the word that introduces the series (to ___, to ___, to ___). If one line does not fit the same slot, it breaks parallelism. Fix it before moving on.

CSS TRAP

The error hides most often in long sentences where the final item drifts into a different form. Examiners scan exactly these tail-end items. Always re-read the last element of any list against the first.

3. Practice Set

Rewrite each sentence so that the parallel elements match in form.

1. The course teaches reading, writing, and how to speak well.
2. She is admired for her honesty, her courage, and because she works hard.
3. The government promised to lower taxes, create jobs, and that it would build schools.
4. He neither apologised nor did he explain.
5. Good governance means listening to people, to act on evidence, and being accountable.
6. Writing essays is more demanding than to attempt the precis.
7. The plan is both ambitious and it costs a lot.
8. We came, we saw, and conquering followed.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The course teaches reading, writing, and speaking. (Three gerunds.)
2. She is admired for her honesty, her courage, and her diligence. (Three matched noun phrases.)
3. ...promised to lower taxes, create jobs, and build schools. (Three bare infinitives after to.)
4. He neither apologised nor explained. (Two matched past-tense verbs after neither ... nor.)
5. ...means listening to people, acting on evidence, and being accountable. (Three gerunds.)
6. Writing essays is more demanding than attempting the precis. (Gerund vs. gerund.)
7. The plan is both ambitious and expensive. (Two adjectives after both ... and.)
8. We came, we saw, we conquered. (Three matched clauses.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A parallelism repair sheet: ten faulty sentences with corrections, plus five original sentences using correlative conjunctions correctly.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I check that every item in a series shares one form?
- Do I balance both halves of not only ... but also?
- Do I re-read the last item in every list?

Day 16 Phase 2 Review Test

PHASE 2 · STRUCTURE & COHESION · DAY 16 OF 30

Goal: Consolidate Days 9-15 under timed conditions: voice, verbals, modifiers, articles, prepositions, advanced punctuation, and parallelism.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

This is your second checkpoint. The skills in Phase 2 are where most CSS candidates either pull ahead or stall. A clear-eyed audit now tells you exactly where to spend the rest of the course.

1. Learn the Rule

How to take this test

Give yourself fifty minutes, closed-book. Do every section in order. Only after finishing should you open the answer key and mark honestly, noting the rule behind each error.

- Target: 80% or higher across all sections before moving to Phase 3.
- Any section below 70% means revisit that day before continuing.

Section A - Voice and verbals (Days 9-10)

Convert or correct as instructed.

- 1. It was decided by the board to merge the two departments. (Improve.)
- 2. Walking to the office, the rain soaked the minister. (Fix the dangler.)
- 3. The report needs revised before submission. (Correct the verbal.)

Section B - Modifiers and articles (Days 11-12)

Repair the placement or the article.

- 4. He almost read the whole report. (Place the modifier to mean he read nearly all of it.)
- 5. Corruption is the biggest threat to the development. (Fix the article.)
- 6. She gave a useful advice. (Correct.)

Section C - Prepositions, punctuation, parallelism (Days 13-15)

Correct each sentence.

- 7. The policy resulted into a crisis.
- 8. We must reform three sectors energy, water, and health.
- 9. The plan aims to cut waste, improving services, and to raise trust.
- 10. The economy is recovering, however inflation remains high.

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
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Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Test	<i>Ten items, three sections, fifty minutes.</i>	Simulates the grammar load of a real CSS correction question.
Scoring	<i>Mark each item right or wrong, then name the rule.</i>	Naming the rule is what converts a mistake into learning.
Target	<i>80% to advance; below 70% in any section means revise.</i>	Be strict the real exam will be.

MENTOR'S TIP

After marking, do not just count the score. Group your errors by Phase 2 day. If three of your four errors trace back to one day, that day is your single highest-value revision before Phase 3. Precision beats volume.

CSS TRAP

Resist checking answers section by section. The discipline of finishing all ten under time, then marking, is what trains exam temperament. Spot-marking inflates your score and hides your real weak points.

3. Practice Set

Below is the consolidated answer key. Mark only after completing all ten items above.

1. Item 1 voice (Day 9)
2. Item 2 dangling participle (Day 10/11)
3. Item 3 verbal form (Day 10)
4. Item 4 misplaced modifier (Day 11)
5. Item 5 article (Day 12)
6. Item 6 countable/uncountable + article (Day 12)
7. Item 7 preposition (Day 13)
8. Item 8 colon (Day 14)
9. Item 9 parallelism (Day 15)
10. Item 10 semicolon with conjunctive adverb (Day 14)

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. The board decided to merge the two departments. (Active voice names the actor.)
2. Walking to the office, the minister was soaked by the rain. (The subject must be the one walking.)
3. The report needs revising / needs to be revised before submission. (needs + gerund or needs to be + participle.)
4. He read almost the whole report. (almost modifies the whole report, not read.)
5. Corruption is the biggest threat to development. (No article before the abstract general noun

development.)

6. She gave useful advice. (advice is uncountable no a.)
7. The policy resulted in a crisis. (result in.)
8. We must reform three sectors: energy, water, and health. (Colon after a complete clause.)
9. The plan aims to cut waste, improve services, and raise trust. (Three parallel infinitives.)
10. The economy is recovering; however, inflation remains high. (Semicolon before however.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Your marked test with a short error-analysis note: which Phase 2 day each mistake came from, and your one priority revision before Phase 3.

Self-check before you stop:

- Did I score 80% or higher overall?
- Is every section at or above 70%?
- Have I identified my single weakest Phase 2 topic?

PHASE 3Days 17–22

Nuance and Formality

Write with control and sophistication connected, register-aware sentences that read like a mature CSS candidate, not a textbook.

Day 17 Sentence Connectors and Cohesion

PHASE 3 · NUANCE & FORMALITY · DAY 17 OF 30

Goal: Link sentences and paragraphs with the right connector so that ideas flow logically instead of sitting in disconnected blocks.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

An essay is judged as much on cohesion as on content. The right transition signals the examiner exactly how each idea relates to the last cause, contrast, addition, result and makes your argument feel inevitable.

1. Learn the Rule

Match the connector to the logical relationship

Every transition encodes a specific relationship. Using the wrong one confuses the reader even when the sentence is grammatical. Learn the families.

- *Addition: moreover, furthermore, in addition*
- *Contrast: however, nevertheless, on the contrary, conversely*
- *Cause/result: therefore, consequently, hence, as a result*
- *Concession: although, even though, granted that, admittedly*

Punctuate conjunctive adverbs correctly

Words like however, therefore, and moreover are adverbs, not conjunctions. They cannot join two clauses with only a comma. Use a semicolon (or a full stop) before, and a comma after.

- *Wrong: The plan was sound, however it was never funded.*
- *Right: The plan was sound; however, it was never funded.*

Do not overload the opening

One connector per sentence is plenty. Stacking them (but however, and moreover) signals weak control. Vary their position too a connector can sit mid-sentence.

- *Heavy: However, moreover, the policy also failed.*
- *Better: The policy, moreover, failed on its own terms.*

Cohesion also comes from reference and repetition

Connectors are not the only glue. Pronouns, repeated key terms, and this/such + noun tie sentences together without a transition word in front of every sentence.

- *The court struck down the law. This ruling reshaped the debate.*
- *Reforms were promised. Such promises had been made before.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wrong	<i>Inflation rose, therefore the public suffered.</i>	Comma splice: ...rose; therefore, the public suffered.
Strong	<i>The bill passed easily; nevertheless, its critics were not silenced.</i>	Semicolon + conjunctive adverb + comma textbook cohesion.
Weak	<i>And also moreover the economy declined.</i>	Connector overload: The economy, moreover, declined.
Cohesive	<i>The state ignored the warning. That negligence proved costly.</i>	Reference (that negligence) links without a transition word.

MENTOR'S TIP

Build a transition palette of three to four reliable connectors for each relationship and rotate them. Examiners notice when a candidate writes however nine times. Variety in transitions is a quiet marker of range.

CSS TRAP

Do not start every single sentence with a connector. Mature writing earns its flow from logical order first and transitions second. A connector in front of a sentence that does not actually contrast or add is worse than none.

3. Practice Set

Insert the most precise connector, and punctuate it correctly. State the relationship it signals.

1. The reforms were announced with fanfare ___ they were quietly abandoned.
2. The economy grew ___ the benefits never reached the poor.
3. Taxes were raised ___ the deficit widened anyway.
4. The argument is logical ___ it ignores the human cost. (concession)
5. The court ruled against the state ___ the policy was withdrawn. (result)
6. Corruption persists ___ the laws against it are strong. (contrast)
7. The plan was underfunded ___ poorly designed ___ doomed. (addition then result)
8. The minister denied the charge ___ the evidence said otherwise.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. ...with fanfare; however, they were quietly abandoned. (contrast.)
2. The economy grew; nevertheless, the benefits never reached the poor. (contrast/concession.)
3. Taxes were raised; nonetheless, the deficit widened anyway. (contrast.)
4. The argument is logical, although it ignores the human cost. (concession; subordinator, comma before.)
5. The court ruled against the state; consequently, the policy was withdrawn. (result.)

6. Corruption persists even though the laws against it are strong. (contrast/concession.)
7. The plan was underfunded and poorly designed; as a result, it was doomed. (addition then result.)
8. The minister denied the charge; however, the evidence said otherwise. (contrast.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A connector map: each logical relationship (addition, contrast, cause, concession, sequence) with three or four connectors and one model sentence per relationship.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I punctuate conjunctive adverbs with a semicolon and comma?
- Can I match a connector to the exact relationship I mean?
- Do I vary my transitions instead of repeating however?

Day 18 Common CSS Grammar Traps

PHASE 3 · NUANCE & FORMALITY · DAY 18 OF 30

Goal: Recognise and eliminate the specific high-frequency errors that recur in CSS scripts year after year.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Examiners see the same handful of mistakes thousands of times. Knowing exactly which traps they hunt for lets you defend against them deliberately and a clean script stands out immediately.

1. Learn the Rule

The double comparative and superlative

Never combine more or most with the -er or -est ending. One marker of comparison is enough.

→ *Wrong: This is more easier than that.*

→ *Right: This is easier than that.*

Confusing its / it's, their / there / they're, your / you're

These homophones are the most penalised slips in the exam because they signal carelessness rather than ignorance.

→ *its = possessive; it's = it is/has*

→ *their = possessive; there = place; they're = they are*

The redundant subject pronoun

Do not restate the subject with a pronoun after naming it a common South Asian English habit.

→ *Wrong: The minister he resigned yesterday.*

→ *Right: The minister resigned yesterday.*

Tense drift and wrong prepositions of time

Keep the tense consistent within a passage, and use since with a point in time, for with a duration.

→ *Wrong: He is working here since 2010.*

→ *Right: He has been working here since 2010.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wrong	<i>It is the most unique solution available.</i>	unique is absolute: It is a unique solution.
Faulty	<i>The government they failed to act.</i>	Drop the redundant pronoun: The government failed to act.
Wrong	<i>Pakistan is facing this crisis since many years.</i>	...has been facing this crisis for many years.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Correct	<i>Its impact on the economy was severe.</i>	Possessive its no apostrophe.

MENTOR'S TIP

Make a personal hit-list of the five traps you fall into most, and run a targeted final-minute scan for exactly those on every script. You cannot proofread for everything in two minutes, but you can hunt your own top five.

CSS TRAP

Absolute adjectives unique, perfect, complete, ideal, supreme cannot be compared or intensified. Most unique and very perfect are errors examiners pounce on because they look like vocabulary showing off gone wrong.

3. Practice Set

Find and fix the trap in each sentence. Name the error type.

1. This proposal is more better than the last one.
2. The committee it submitted its report on time.
3. Their going to announce the results tomorrow.
4. He is living in Islamabad since 2015.
5. It was the most perfect example of misgovernance.
6. The policy lost it's credibility within a year.
7. Each of the candidates have submitted their forms.
8. The country is facing inflation from a long time.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. This proposal is better than the last one. (Double comparative drop more.)
2. The committee submitted its report on time. (Redundant subject pronoun removed.)
3. They're going to announce the results tomorrow. (their > they're.)
4. He has been living in Islamabad since 2015. (Present perfect continuous with since.)
5. It was a perfect example of misgovernance. (perfect is absolute drop most.)
6. The policy lost its credibility within a year. (its = possessive, no apostrophe.)
7. Each of the candidates has submitted his or her form. (each is singular.)
8. The country has been facing inflation for a long time. (for a duration + present perfect.)

5. Close the Day**TODAY'S DELIVERABLE**

Your personal Top Five Traps card: the five errors you make most, each with the rule and a corrected example, to scan for on every script.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I spot a double comparative instantly?
- Am I secure on its/it's, their/there/they're, your/you're?
- Do I use since vs. for and the right tense for ongoing actions?

Day 19 Modal Verbs and Hypotheticals

PHASE 3 · NUANCE & FORMALITY · DAY 19 OF 30

Goal: Use modal verbs to express precise degrees of certainty, obligation, and possibility, and to hedge claims appropriately.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Mature argument is rarely absolute. Modals let you calibrate exactly how strongly you commit to a claim the difference between this will happen and this may happen is the difference between overstatement and judgement.

1. Learn the Rule

Modals of certainty and deduction

Rank your confidence: must (near-certain), should/ought to (expected), may/might/could (possible), cannot (impossible).

- *The figures must be wrong. (strong deduction)*
- *Reform might ease the crisis. (tentative possibility)*

Modals of obligation and advice

must and have to express strong obligation; should and ought to give advice or expectation; need not removes obligation.

- *The state must protect minorities. (duty)*
- *Policy should be evidence-based. (recommendation)*

Perfect modals for the past

modal + have + past participle comments on past events: speculation (may have), criticism (should have), or counterfactual regret (could have, would have).

- *The crisis could have been avoided. (it was possible but did not happen)*
- *The government should have acted sooner. (criticism of a past failure)*

Hedging for academic tone

Replace flat assertions with measured ones using modals and qualifiers it appears that, this may suggest, one could argue. This reads as judgement, not arrogance.

- *Overstated: This proves the policy failed.*
- *Measured: This suggests the policy may have failed.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Strong	<i>The state must guarantee free and fair elections.</i>	must = unambiguous obligation.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Measured	<i>Such reforms could reduce inequality over time.</i>	could hedges a forward claim sensibly.
Criticism	<i>The regulator should have intervened earlier.</i>	should have + participle judges a past failure.
Wrong	<i>The economy will definitely recover next year.</i>	Overcommitted: ...may recover / is likely to recover.

MENTOR'S TIP

When you make a prediction or a causal claim in an essay, ask whether you can actually guarantee it. If not, downgrade will to may, is to appears to be. Examiners trust a writer who shows calibrated judgement far more than one who overstates.

CSS TRAP

Do not confuse the perfect modals. Should have done means it did not happen and that was a mistake; must have done means you deduce it did happen. Writing it must have been prevented when you mean it should have been prevented reverses your meaning entirely.

3. Practice Set

Choose or correct the modal to fit the meaning in brackets.

1. The minister ___ resign; the scandal is too large to survive. (strong expectation)
2. We ___ have prevented the famine if we had acted on the early warnings. (past possibility, unrealised)
3. The data ___ be incomplete; the totals do not add up. (strong deduction)
4. Citizens ___ have the right to information. (obligation/right)
5. The reform will definitely solve poverty. (Hedge this claim.)
6. The government must have acted sooner. (Intended meaning: criticism. Correct it.)
7. Students ___ submit the form by Friday; it is not optional. (obligation)
8. This proves beyond doubt that the policy worked. (Make it measured.)

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The minister should resign; the scandal is too large to survive. (expectation/advice.)
2. We could have prevented the famine... (unrealised past possibility.)
3. The data must be incomplete... (strong deduction in the present.)
4. Citizens must have the right to information. (obligation/entitlement.)
5. The reform may / is likely to ease poverty. (Hedged forward claim.)
6. The government should have acted sooner. (Criticism of a past failure, not deduction.)
7. Students must submit the form by Friday... (firm obligation.)
8. This suggests that the policy may have worked. (Measured academic tone.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A modality ladder: each modal placed on a scale of certainty and of obligation, with one current-affairs sentence illustrating each.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I rank modals by degree of certainty and obligation?
- Do I use perfect modals correctly for past speculation and regret?
- Do I hedge claims I cannot fully guarantee?

Day 20 Degrees of Comparison

PHASE 3 · NUANCE & FORMALITY · DAY 20 OF 30

Goal: Form and use comparatives and superlatives correctly, and build clean, logical, complete comparisons.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Comparison is central to analysis this policy is more effective than that one, this is the gravest threat. Flawed comparisons quietly undermine otherwise sharp arguments, and the errors are easy for examiners to spot.

1. Learn the Rule

Forming comparatives and superlatives

One syllable: add -er/-est (fast, faster, fastest). Two-plus syllables: use more/most (effective, more effective, most effective). Some are irregular (good/better/best, bad/worse/worst, little/less/least).

- *Correct: more transparent, the most transparent*
- *Wrong: transparenter, transparentest*

Comparative for two, superlative for three or more

Use the comparative when comparing exactly two things, the superlative for three or more.

- *Of the two options, this is the better one. (not the best)*
- *Of all the options, this is the best one.*

Complete the comparison

Always state both sides. A dangling comparison (more efficient than what?) is incomplete and vague.

- *Incomplete: This system is more efficient.*
- *Complete: This system is more efficient than the old one.*

Compare like with like

Make sure the two things compared are genuinely comparable compare a policy with a policy, not a policy with a country.

- *Wrong: Pakistan's literacy rate is lower than Sri Lanka. (rate vs. country)*
- *Right: Pakistan's literacy rate is lower than Sri Lanka's.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wrong	<i>This is the most worst crisis in our history.</i>	Double superlative: the worst crisis.
Faulty	<i>Our economy is bigger than Bangladesh.</i>	Compare economies: ...bigger than

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
		Bangladesh's / than that of Bangladesh.
Wrong	<i>Of the two reforms, the land reform was the most urgent.</i>	Two items take the comparative: the more urgent.
Correct	<i>This is by far the most comprehensive report to date.</i>	Correct superlative for three or more, intensified by by far.

MENTOR'S TIP

Whenever you write a comparative, immediately check for the word than and ask than what. If the second half is missing or mismatched, complete it. A finished comparison is one of the clearest signs of careful writing.

CSS TRAP

The than what error is everywhere in exam scripts: women are more empowered today (than when?), the situation is worse (than what?). An incomplete comparison reads as a half-finished thought. Always supply the second term.

3. Practice Set

Correct or complete each comparison.

1. This is the most cleanest water available in the region.
2. Of the two candidates, she is the most qualified.
3. Punjab's population is larger than Sindh.
4. Education today is more important. (Complete the comparison.)
5. He is more taller than his brother.
6. This is the worse decision the cabinet has ever made.
7. The new policy is less effective. (Complete it.)
8. Our exports are higher than last year.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. This is the cleanest water available in the region. (Drop most before a superlative form.)
2. Of the two candidates, she is the more qualified. (Two items comparative.)
3. Punjab's population is larger than Sindh's / than that of Sindh. (Compare populations.)
4. Education today is more important than ever / than it once was. (Comparison completed.)
5. He is taller than his brother. (Double comparative drop more.)
6. This is the worst decision the cabinet has ever made. (Superlative for the whole set.)
7. The new policy is less effective than the previous one. (Second term supplied.)
8. Our exports are higher than last year's. (Compare like with like.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A comparison drill sheet: ten completed comparisons drawn from current affairs, each compared like with like, plus the irregular comparison forms memorised.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I avoid double comparatives and superlatives?
- Do I use the comparative for two and superlative for three or more?
- Do I complete every comparison and compare like with like?

Day 21 Commonly Confused Words

PHASE 3 · NUANCE & FORMALITY · DAY 21 OF 30

Goal: Distinguish the word pairs most often misused in formal writing, so that meaning is never blurred by the wrong choice.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

A single confused word affect for effect, principal for principle can change or muddy your meaning and signal a shaky command of English. These pairs appear constantly in CSS correction questions.

1. Learn the Rule

The classic meaning pairs

Learn these by meaning, not by spelling. Each pair carries a genuine distinction.

- *affect* (verb, to influence) vs. *effect* (noun, a result; rarely a verb, to bring about)
- *principal* (chief / head) vs. *principle* (a rule or belief)
- *complement* (to complete) vs. *compliment* (to praise)

Quantity and number pairs

These depend on countability and were touched on earlier master them fully now.

- *fewer* (countable) vs. *less* (uncountable)
- *number* (countable) vs. *amount* (uncountable)
- *between* (two) vs. *among* (three or more)

Subtle formal pairs

These trip up even strong writers and are favourites of examiners.

- *comprise* (the whole comprises the parts; never comprised of) vs. *compose*
- *ensure* (make certain) vs. *insure* (cover financially) vs. *assure* (reassure a person)
- *stationary* (not moving) vs. *stationery* (writing material)

Words often swapped in argument

Misusing these distorts analysis.

- *imply* (the speaker suggests) vs. *infer* (the listener deduces)
- *economic* (of the economy) vs. *economical* (thrifty)
- *continuous* (unbroken) vs. *continual* (repeated)

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wrong	The new tax will effect every household.	affect (verb): ...will affect every household.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Correct	<i>The reforms had a lasting effect on the economy.</i>	effect (noun) = result.
Wrong	<i>The cabinet is comprised of fifteen members.</i>	comprises never comprised of: The cabinet comprises fifteen members.
Faulty	<i>There were less applicants this year.</i>	Countable: fewer applicants.

MENTOR'S TIP

For affect vs. effect, remember RAVEN: Remember, Affect is a Verb, Effect is a Noun (in the vast majority of cases). For comprise, fix one sentence in memory the whole comprises the parts and never write comprised of again.

CSS TRAP

imply and infer are reversed constantly. The writer or speaker implies (puts the meaning in); the reader or listener infers (takes the meaning out). Writing the passage infers that when you mean implies is a meaning error, not just a word slip.

3. Practice Set

Choose the correct word, or correct the wrong one. Be ready to explain the distinction.

1. The medicine had no (affect / effect) on the patient.
2. She is a woman of strong (principals / principles).
3. The federation (comprises / is comprised of) four provinces.
4. There is a large (amount / number) of unemployed graduates.
5. The author (implies / infers) that reform is overdue; the reader (implies / infers) the same.
6. We must (ensure / insure) that every vote is counted.
7. The traffic was (stationary / stationery) for an hour.
8. The policy aims to reduce (continuous / continual) interruptions to supply.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. ...no effect on the patient. (effect = noun, result.)
2. ...a woman of strong principles. (principles = beliefs.)
3. The federation comprises four provinces. (comprise, never comprised of.)
4. ...a large number of unemployed graduates. (graduates are countable.)
5. The author implies...; the reader infers... (writer implies, reader infers.)
6. We must ensure that every vote is counted. (ensure = make certain.)
7. The traffic was stationary for an hour. (stationary = not moving.)
8. ...reduce continual interruptions to supply. (continual = repeated, on and off.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A confused-words master list: thirty pairs with a one-line distinction and one correct example each, kept for final-week revision.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I use affect/effect and principal/principle without hesitation?
- Do I keep fewer/less and number/amount tied to countability?
- Do I keep imply and infer the right way round?

Day 22 Phase 3 Review Test

PHASE 3 · NUANCE & FORMALITY · DAY 22 OF 30

Goal: Consolidate Days 17-21 under timed conditions: cohesion, CSS traps, modals, comparison, and confused words.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Phase 3 is where grammar becomes style. This checkpoint tells you whether you can now write with control and nuance, not merely correctness the threshold the best CSS scripts cross.

1. Learn the Rule

How to take this test

Fifty minutes, closed-book, all sections in order. Mark afterwards against the key, naming the rule behind every error.

- Target: 80% or higher overall before Phase 4.
- Any section below 70% means revisit that day.

Section A - Cohesion and traps (Days 17-18)

Fix the connector or the trap.

- 1. The plan was sound, however it was never funded.
- 2. The government they ignored the warning.
- 3. He is working in this department since 2018.

Section B - Modals and comparison (Days 19-20)

Correct the modal or the comparison.

- 4. The crisis must have been avoided if we had acted. (Intended: unrealised past possibility.)
- 5. Of the two policies, this is the best.
- 6. Punjab's economy is larger than Sindh.

Section C - Confused words and combined nuance (Day 21 + review)

Choose or correct.

- 7. The tax will effect every household.
- 8. The federation is comprised of four provinces.
- 9. There were less voters than expected.
- 10. This proves beyond doubt the policy worked. (Make it measured.)

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
--------	----------	------------------

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Test	<i>Ten items, three sections, fifty minutes.</i>	Targets the nuance skills of Phase 3.
Scoring	<i>Right or wrong, then name the rule and the day.</i>	Trace every error to its lesson.
Target	<i>80% to advance; below 70% means revise that day.</i>	Hold the standard.

MENTOR'S TIP

Phase 3 errors are often invisible to the writer because the sentence sounds fine. After marking, read each corrected sentence aloud beside your original hearing the difference is how nuance becomes instinct.

CSS TRAP

Do not treat the hedging and modality items as optional polish. An overstated claim (this proves...) is marked as a reasoning flaw, not just a style preference. Calibrated language is a scored skill.

3. Practice Set

Consolidated answer key. Complete all ten items first, then mark.

1. Item 1 conjunctive adverb punctuation (Day 17)
2. Item 2 redundant subject pronoun (Day 18)
3. Item 3 tense with since (Day 18)
4. Item 4 perfect modal meaning (Day 19)
5. Item 5 comparative for two (Day 20)
6. Item 6 compare like with like (Day 20)
7. Item 7 affect/effect (Day 21)
8. Item 8 comprise (Day 21)
9. Item 9 fewer/less (Day 21)
10. Item 10 hedging/modality (Day 19)

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The plan was sound; however, it was never funded. (Semicolon + comma.)
2. The government ignored the warning. (Redundant pronoun removed.)
3. He has been working in this department since 2018. (Present perfect continuous.)
4. The crisis could have been avoided if we had acted. (Unrealised past possibility, not deduction.)
5. Of the two policies, this is the better one. (Comparative for two.)
6. Punjab's economy is larger than Sindh's / than that of Sindh. (Compare economies.)
7. The tax will affect every household. (affect = verb.)

8. The federation comprises four provinces. (No comprised of.)
9. There were fewer voters than expected. (Countable.)
10. This strongly suggests the policy worked. / ...may have worked. (Measured.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Your marked test plus an error-analysis note identifying your weakest Phase 3 day and one priority fix before Phase 4.

Self-check before you stop:

- Did I score 80% or higher overall?
- Is every section at or above 70%?
- Can I now write with deliberate nuance, not just correctness?

PHASE 4Days 23–27

Precision and Rhetoric

Turn correct, connected prose into persuasive, varied, economical writing the rhetorical control that lifts a script into the top band.

Day 23 Cleft Sentences and Inversion

PHASE 4 · PRECISION & RHETORIC · DAY 23 OF 30

Goal: Use cleft sentences and inversion to place emphasis exactly where you want it and to add rhythmic variety.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Top scripts do not just state ideas; they emphasise them. Cleft structures and inversion are the tools that let you foreground the most important part of a sentence and break the monotony of subject-verb-object.

1. Learn the Rule

It-cleft for emphasis

Split a sentence with *It is/was ... that ...* to spotlight one element.

- *Plain: The army restored order in 1999.*
- *Cleft: It was the army that restored order in 1999. (emphasis on the actor)*

What-cleft (pseudo-cleft)

Begin with a *What* clause to foreground what follows.

- *Plain: The country needs honest leadership.*
- *Cleft: What the country needs is honest leadership.*

Inversion after negative adverbials

When a sentence opens with a negative or restrictive adverbial *never*, *rarely*, *not only*, *seldom*, *hardly*, *no sooner*, *under no circumstances* invert subject and auxiliary, as in a question.

- *Plain: The state has rarely faced such a threat.*
- *Inverted: Rarely has the state faced such a threat.*

Inversion with only and so

Only then, only by, not until, and so + adjective also trigger inversion.

- *Only by reforming the tax system can the deficit be controlled.*
- *So severe was the crisis that the government fell.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Plain	<i>Corruption is the real obstacle to growth.</i>	Cleft: It is corruption that is the real obstacle to growth.
Rhetorical	<i>Never before had the institution faced such scrutiny.</i>	Inversion after never before formal and emphatic.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Strong	<i>What matters most is implementation, not intention.</i>	What-cleft foregrounds implementation.
Inverted	<i>Not only did the policy fail, but it also deepened the crisis.</i>	not only ... but also with inversion in the first clause.

MENTOR'S TIP

Use these sparingly one or two per essay, at the moments you most want the examiner to pause. Their power comes from contrast with your normal sentence flow. A page full of inversions reads as strained, not sophisticated.

CSS TRAP

After a fronted negative adverbial you must invert, and you must not double the negative. Never I have seen is wrong on two counts; write Never have I seen. And do not add an extra not Hardly had he arrived (not Hardly had he not arrived).

3. Practice Set

Rewrite each sentence using the structure named in brackets.

1. The judiciary protected the constitution. (It-cleft, emphasise the judiciary.)
2. The economy needs structural reform, not slogans. (What-cleft.)
3. The country has seldom been so divided. (Inversion with seldom.)
4. We can solve this only by working together. (Inversion with only by.)
5. The flood was so devastating that whole districts were submerged. (Inversion with so.)
6. The minister not only denied the charge but also blamed the press. (Inversion with not only.)
7. He had no sooner taken office than the crisis erupted. (Inversion with no sooner.)
8. Real change is what the people are demanding. (What-cleft, front it.)

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. It was the judiciary that protected the constitution. (It-cleft on the actor.)
2. What the economy needs is structural reform, not slogans. (What-cleft.)
3. Seldom has the country been so divided. (Invert after seldom.)
4. Only by working together can we solve this. (Invert after only by.)
5. So devastating was the flood that whole districts were submerged. (Invert after so + adjective.)
6. Not only did the minister deny the charge, but he also blamed the press. (Invert in the not only clause.)
7. No sooner had he taken office than the crisis erupted. (Invert after no sooner; pair with than.)
8. What the people are demanding is real change. (What-cleft fronted.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A rhetoric bank: three it-clefts, three what-clefts, and four inversions on current-affairs themes, each marked with the element it emphasises.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I form it-clefts and what-clefts to shift emphasis?
- Do I invert correctly after a fronted negative adverbial?
- Do I use these structures sparingly, for effect?

Day 24 Register Control

PHASE 4 • PRECISION & RHETORIC • DAY 24 OF 30

Goal: Hold a consistent formal academic register, eliminating the casual, the colloquial, and the over-inflated alike.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

CSS writing demands a specific register: formal but clear, dignified but not pompous. Slipping into slang loses marks; reaching for swollen vocabulary loses them too. Control is the goal.

1. Learn the Rule

Replace contractions and colloquialisms

In formal writing, expand contractions and remove conversational fillers.

- *Casual:* don't, can't, a lot of, kids, stuff
- *Formal:* do not, cannot, many / a great deal of, children, matters / issues

Prefer precise verbs to vague phrasal verbs

Where a single formal verb exists, it usually reads better than a phrasal verb in academic prose.

- *Casual:* look into, find out, get rid of, put up with
- *Formal:* investigate, ascertain, eliminate, tolerate

Avoid both slang and inflated jargon

Register fails in two directions. Slang is too low; thesaurus-padding is too high. Aim for the clear formal middle.

- *Too low:* The government messed up big time.
- *Too high:* The government's praxis evinced egregious infelicities.
- *Right:* The government handled the situation poorly.

Keep tone impersonal and measured

Limit first-person outbursts and emotional intensifiers (totally, absolutely, hate). Let evidence carry the weight.

- *Emotional:* This policy is absolutely terrible and I hate it.
- *Measured:* This policy is deeply flawed and difficult to defend.

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Casual	<i>The govt didn't do anything about it.</i>	Formal: The government took no action on the matter.
Inflated	<i>The utilisation of efficacious methodologies is</i>	Plainer: Effective methods are essential.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>imperative.</i>	
Right	<i>The reform addressed only the symptoms, not the causes.</i>	Clear, formal, measured the target register.
Emotional	<i>It's a total disaster, honestly.</i>	Measured: The outcome has been deeply damaging.

MENTOR'S TIP

Build two short personal lists: ten casual words you overuse with their formal equivalents, and five inflated words you reach for that you should simplify. Register control is mostly a matter of catching your own habitual extremes in both directions.

CSS TRAP

Do not equate formality with long words. Examiners penalise pompous, padded prose as heavily as slang. *utilise* is not better than *use*; *commence* is not better than *begin* unless the context truly calls for it. The clearest formal word wins.

3. Practice Set

Rewrite each sentence in a consistent formal academic register fixing whichever direction it errs in.

1. The government didn't really get its act together on the economy.
2. The aforementioned utilisation of resources was suboptimal in nature.
3. Kids these days don't have a lot of job options.
4. The policy was a complete and utter disaster, to be honest.
5. We need to find out what went wrong and get rid of the bad actors.
6. The minister's speech was, like, totally unconvincing.
7. The commencement of the implementation of the policy was effectuated in January.
8. There's tons of corruption and nobody's doing anything.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. The government failed to manage the economy effectively. (Slang removed.)
2. The use of resources was inadequate. (Inflation stripped out.)
3. Young people today have few employment opportunities. (Formal and clear.)
4. The policy was a serious failure. (Emotion measured; no to be honest.)
5. We must ascertain what went wrong and remove those responsible. (Phrasal verbs upgraded.)
6. The minister's speech was wholly unconvincing. (Filler and slang removed.)
7. The policy was implemented in January. (De-inflated.)
8. Corruption is widespread, and little is being done to address it. (Slang removed, measured tone.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A register-control sheet: your top ten casual-to-formal swaps and five inflated-to-plain swaps, with one rewritten sentence demonstrating each.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I expand contractions and remove slang in formal writing?
- Do I resist padding my prose with inflated vocabulary?
- Is my tone impersonal, measured, and consistent?

Day 25 Concision and Eliminating Redundancy

PHASE 4 · PRECISION & RHETORIC · DAY 25 OF 30

Goal: Cut wordiness, redundancy, and filler so that every sentence carries its full weight in the fewest necessary words.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Under exam time pressure, economy is power. A concise sentence is clearer, more forceful, and frees words for analysis. Examiners reward writing that says more in less and penalise padding.

1. Learn the Rule

Cut redundant pairs and doublets

English is full of habitual redundancies where one word already contains the other's meaning.

- *Redundant: final outcome, basic fundamentals, past history, end result, advance planning*
- *Concise: outcome, fundamentals, history, result, planning*

Replace wordy phrases with single words

Long connective phrases can almost always shrink.

- *due to the fact that = because; in order to = to; at this point in time = now*
- *in the event that = if; a large number of = many; despite the fact that = although*

Cut empty openers and fillers

Phrases like it is important to note that and there is/are often delay the real subject.

- *Wordy: It is important to note that corruption undermines growth.*
- *Tight: Corruption undermines growth.*

Prefer the verb to the noun (avoid nominalisation)

Burying the action in a noun bloats the sentence. Let the verb do the work.

- *Heavy: The committee made a decision to conduct an investigation.*
- *Lean: The committee decided to investigate.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Wordy	<i>Due to the fact that the funds were not available, the project was cancelled.</i>	Tight: Because the funds were unavailable, the project was cancelled.
Padded	<i>It is a fact that many a number of people remain poor.</i>	Lean: Many people remain poor.
Heavy	<i>The government undertook the implementation of reforms.</i>	Lean: The government implemented reforms.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Tight	<i>Corruption erodes trust, weakens institutions, and stalls growth.</i>	Three verbs, no filler the target density.

MENTOR'S TIP

After drafting, hunt for these four killers in order: redundant pairs, wordy phrases, empty openers, and nominalisations. Cutting even one per sentence across an essay sharpens the whole script. Aim to remove words without removing meaning.

CSS TRAP

Conciseness does not mean writing in fragments or stripping out necessary qualifiers. Cutting a hedging modal (may, appears) to save a word can overstate your claim. Cut filler, never cut precision.

3. Practice Set

Tighten each sentence without losing meaning.

1. Due to the fact that the economy was weak, investment fell.
2. It is important to note that education is the basic fundamental of progress.
3. The committee made the decision to postpone the meeting.
4. In the event that the bill is passed, it will come into effect immediately.
5. There are many people who believe that reform is necessary.
6. The final end result of the policy was a complete and total failure.
7. At this point in time, we are in the process of conducting a review.
8. Despite the fact that he was warned in advance, he proceeded.

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. Because the economy was weak, investment fell. (due to the fact that > because.)
2. Education is the foundation of progress. (Opener and redundancy cut.)
3. The committee postponed the meeting. (Nominalisation > verb.)
4. If the bill is passed, it will take effect immediately. (in the event that > if.)
5. Many people believe reform is necessary. (there are ... who removed.)
6. The policy failed completely. (Redundant doublets cut.)
7. We are now reviewing it. / We are conducting a review. (Filler removed.)
8. Although he was warned, he proceeded. (despite the fact that > although; in advance redundant with warned.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

A concision worksheet: ten of your own padded sentences rewritten tightly, plus a personal list of the wordy phrases you use most and their one-word replacements.

Self-check before you stop:

- Can I spot and cut redundant pairs?
- Do I replace wordy connectives with single words?
- Do I prefer strong verbs to buried nominalisations?

Day 26 Thematic Progression and Paragraph Flow

PHASE 4 · PRECISION & RHETORIC · DAY 26 OF 30

Goal: Order information within and across sentences so that each new sentence builds naturally on the last, giving paragraphs genuine flow.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Cohesion (Day 17) supplies the connectors; thematic progression supplies the deeper logic of flow how known information leads to new information. This is the skill that makes a paragraph feel like one thought, not a list of sentences.

1. Learn the Rule

The given-new principle

Start a sentence with what the reader already knows (the given) and end it with the new information you want to stress. The end of a sentence is its position of emphasis.

- *Given first, new last: The reforms reduced corruption. This reduction restored public trust.*
- *The repeated idea (reduction) links the sentences; the new idea (trust) lands at the end.*

Three progression patterns

Sentences typically connect in one of three ways: constant theme (same subject continues), linear theme (the new idea of one sentence becomes the subject of the next), or split theme (a stated pair is taken up in order).

- *Linear: The state launched a programme. The programme targeted rural poverty. That poverty had deepened since 2018.*

Put the topic sentence first, then develop

Open each paragraph with its controlling idea, then let every following sentence support, explain, or illustrate it. End with a sentence that consolidates or transitions.

- *Topic: Devolution has had mixed results. (then evidence, then a closing judgement)*

Keep one idea per paragraph

A paragraph that tries to do two things flows poorly. Split it. Unity of theme is the foundation of progression.

- *If a paragraph shifts from causes to solutions, start a new paragraph at the shift.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Weak	<i>Corruption is high. Trust is low. Reforms are needed. Funding is short.</i>	Disconnected no given-new thread linking the sentences.
Strong	<i>Corruption remains high. This persistence has</i>	Each sentence reuses the prior idea and

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>eroded public trust. Restoring that trust now demands credible reform.</i>	adds a new one.
Linear	<i>The flood displaced millions. Those displaced crowded into camps. The camps soon lacked clean water.</i>	New idea of each sentence becomes the next subject.
Topic	<i>Devolution has produced uneven gains.</i>	A controlling sentence the rest of the paragraph can develop.

MENTOR'S TIP

Test a paragraph by underlining the first few words of each sentence. If those openings connect logically to the end of the previous sentence, your progression is sound. If every sentence starts cold with a new subject, the paragraph is a list, not an argument.

CSS TRAP

Do not confuse adding connectors with achieving flow. You can have a however in front of every sentence and still have no progression. True flow comes from the order of ideas given before new not from transition words pasted on top of a disordered paragraph.

3. Practice Set

Reorder or rewrite each pair or group so that given information leads to new, and the sentences flow.

- Public trust collapsed. The audit revealed massive fraud. (Reorder for given-new.)
- New schools were built. Literacy then rose. Funding came from a World Bank loan. (Make it flow linearly.)
- Inflation hurt the poor most. Prices rose sharply in 2023. (Reorder.)
- Reforms are needed. Corruption is endemic. (Connect with given-new.)
- The minister resigned. A scandal had engulfed his ministry. (Reorder so the cause precedes the effect.)
- Write a topic sentence for a paragraph about the effects of climate change on Pakistan's agriculture.
- The camps lacked water. Millions were displaced by the flood. They gathered in camps. (Order linearly.)
- Turnout was low. Many citizens had lost faith in the process. (Connect, cause before effect.)

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

- The audit revealed massive fraud. This revelation collapsed public trust. (Cause/given first, new effect last.)
- A World Bank loan funded new schools. Those schools raised literacy. (Linear: loan > schools > literacy.)
- Prices rose sharply in 2023. This inflation hurt the poor most. (Event first, consequence last.)

4. Corruption is endemic. Tackling it demands serious reform. (Given problem first, new response last.)
5. A scandal engulfed his ministry. As a result, the minister resigned. (Cause before effect.)
6. Sample: Climate change is reshaping Pakistan's agriculture in ways that threaten both yields and livelihoods. (Controlling idea the paragraph can develop.)
7. The flood displaced millions. The displaced gathered in camps. Those camps lacked water. (Linear chain.)
8. Many citizens had lost faith in the process. Consequently, turnout was low. (Cause first, effect last.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

One rewritten paragraph (six to eight sentences) on a current-affairs topic, with the given-new thread marked, plus a topic sentence drafted for three different essay themes.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I end sentences with the new, emphatic information?
- Does each sentence opening connect to the previous sentence's close?
- Does each paragraph develop a single controlling idea?

Day 27 Phase 4 Review

PHASE 4 · PRECISION & RHETORIC · DAY 27 OF 30

Goal: Consolidate Days 23-26 by editing a flawed passage for emphasis, register, concision, and flow the way you will edit your own exam answers.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

Phase 4 skills are editing skills. This review is therefore not a gap-fill but a holistic edit the exact discipline you need in the last minutes of a paper, when raising a script from good to excellent.

1. Learn the Rule

How to do this review

Take forty-five minutes. Read the flawed passage below, then rewrite it fully, applying all four Phase 4 skills. Only then compare with the model rewrite in the answer key.

- Judge yourself on four axes: *emphasis (Day 23), register (Day 24), concision (Day 25), flow (Day 26)*.
- Aim to cut at least a quarter of the words while sharpening the meaning.

The flawed passage to edit

Rewrite the following into a single tight, formal, well-flowing paragraph:

- “Due to the fact that corruption is a really big problem, it’s a fact that the government didn’t manage to do much about it. There are many reforms that were announced. However the reforms were never funded. Trust got eroded. The final end result was that people lost faith.”

What to check in your rewrite

Run the four-point checklist over your version.

- Did I cut filler (*due to the fact that, it’s a fact that, final end result*)?
- Did I fix register (*really big, didn’t, got eroded*)?
- Did I create flow (*given-new*) and use one emphatic structure?

Self-scoring

Give one mark each for emphasis, register, concision, and flow; one for accuracy. Five out of five means you are ready for the final phase.

- 4-5: excellent editing control.
- Below 3: re-read the relevant Phase 4 day before Phase 5.

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Task	<i>Edit one flawed passage, applying all four Phase 4 skills.</i>	Holistic editing, not isolated drills.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Target	<i>Cut ~25% of words while sharpening meaning.</i>	Economy plus precision.
Scoring	<i>One mark each: emphasis, register, concision, flow, accuracy.</i>	Five points total.

MENTOR'S TIP

There is no single correct rewrite editing is judgement. Compare your version with the model not to match it word for word, but to see whether you made the same kinds of decisions: cutting the same filler, fixing the same register slips, building the same given-new flow.

CSS TRAP

Do not over-edit into blandness. The goal is a tight, formal, flowing paragraph that still has force ideally with one well-placed emphatic structure. Stripping all rhythm out in the name of concision is its own failure.

3. Practice Set

After writing your own rewrite, study this model version and the decisions behind it.

1. Decision 1 cut the filler openers (Due to the fact that, it's a fact that, final end result).
2. Decision 2 fix register (really big > serious; didn't manage > failed; got eroded > eroded).
3. Decision 3 apply concision (collapse the short choppy sentences into connected clauses).
4. Decision 4 build given-new flow (corruption > inaction > unfunded reforms > eroded trust > lost faith).
5. Decision 5 add one emphatic structure (a what-cleft or an it-cleft) at the key point.
6. Decision 6 check the final word count is about a quarter shorter.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. Model rewrite: "Corruption is a serious problem, yet the government has failed to confront it. The reforms it announced were never funded, and that neglect steadily eroded public trust. What finally remained was a citizenry that had lost faith in the state."
2. Filler removed: every padded opener is gone.
3. Register fixed: serious, failed, eroded consistently formal.
4. Concision achieved: roughly a third shorter than the original.
5. Flow built: corruption > failure > unfunded reforms > eroded trust > lost faith (given-new chain).
6. Emphasis added: the closing what-cleft (What finally remained...) lands the point.

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Your edited paragraph beside the original, with your five-point self-score and a one-line note on your

weakest Phase 4 skill.

Self-check before you stop:

- Did I cut roughly a quarter of the words?
- Is the register consistently formal and the flow given-to-new?
- Did I place at least one emphatic structure deliberately?

PHASE 5Days 28–30

CSS Mastery and Simulation

*Integrate everything accuracy, structure, nuance, and rhetoric
under exam conditions, and walk into the hall with a tested
method.*

Day 28 Sentence Variety and Emphasis

PHASE 5 · CSS MASTERY · DAY 28 OF 30

Goal: Combine short, long, simple, and complex sentences deliberately to create rhythm, control pace, and stress key ideas.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

A script written entirely in one sentence shape all short and choppy, or all long and tangled tires the examiner. Variety is the final layer of style: it shows you command not just correct sentences but the music of prose.

1. Learn the Rule

Vary sentence length for rhythm

Follow a long, developed sentence with a short, sharp one. The short sentence after a long one delivers impact it is the verbal equivalent of a pause.

→ *The government promised reform across every sector, from taxation to education, and pledged results within a year. None came.*

Vary sentence openings

Do not begin every sentence with the subject. Open sometimes with an adverbial, a participle phrase, a subordinate clause, or a prepositional phrase.

- *Subject: The policy collapsed within months.*
- *Adverbial: Within months, the policy collapsed.*
- *Participle: Lacking funds, the policy collapsed within months.*

Mix the four sentence types

Combine simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences. A run of only complex sentences is as monotonous as a run of only simple ones.

→ *Simple: Reform is overdue. Complex: Although reform is overdue, the will to enact it is absent.*

Use the short sentence for emphasis

Reserve the short, blunt sentence for your most important point. Its brevity makes it land.

→ *The figures were debated, the methods questioned, the motives doubted. The conclusion stood.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Monotone	<i>The economy grew. Inflation rose. Wages stalled. People suffered.</i>	All short choppy. Combine some: As the economy grew, inflation rose and wages stalled, and people suffered.
Strong	<i>For three decades, every government has</i>	Long set-up, short payoff emphatic

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>promised to fix the tax system. None has.</i>	rhythm.
Varied	<i>Lacking both funds and political will, the reform stalled. It was never revived.</i>	Participial opener, then a short closing sentence.
Tangled	<i>The policy, which was announced in a context where, although funds were short, expectations were high, failed.</i>	Over-subordinated break it up.

MENTOR'S TIP

After drafting a paragraph, count the words in each sentence. If three or more in a row are within a few words of each other in length, deliberately lengthen or shorten one. Rhythm comes from contrast, and contrast must be engineered, not hoped for.

CSS TRAP

Variety is a means, not an end. Do not contort a clear sentence into an awkward inverted or over-subordinated shape just to look varied. The short emphatic sentence loses all its power if every third sentence is short. Vary with purpose.

3. Practice Set

Rewrite each item as instructed to improve variety and emphasis.

1. The reform failed. It was underfunded. It lacked support. It collapsed. (Combine into two varied sentences.)
2. The minister resigned after a scandal engulfed his department. (Open with a participle or adverbial.)
3. The crisis deepened, the currency fell, the markets panicked, the government dithered. (End with a short emphatic sentence.)
4. The policy, which was designed by experts who were appointed by a committee that the cabinet formed, failed. (Break up the over-subordination.)
5. The economy is weak. (Expand into a complex sentence with a subordinate clause.)
6. Although the warnings were clear and the data was available and the experts agreed, nothing was done. (Improve the rhythm.)
7. Add a short emphatic sentence after: "For years the state ignored the rising debt, postponing every hard decision and trusting that growth would somehow close the gap."
8. The flood destroyed homes. The flood displaced families. The flood ruined crops. (Combine and vary.)

4. Answer Key**ANSWER KEY**

1. Underfunded and unsupported, the reform was doomed from the start. It collapsed within months. (Participial opener + short close.)

2. After a scandal engulfed his department, the minister resigned. (Subordinate-clause opener.)
3. The crisis deepened, the currency fell, and the markets panicked. The government dithered. (Short emphatic close.)
4. The policy was designed by an expert panel appointed by a cabinet committee. It still failed. (Untangled into two sentences.)
5. Because investment has dried up and exports have stalled, the economy is weak. (Complex sentence.)
6. The warnings were clear, the data available, the experts agreed. Still, nothing was done. (Parallel build + short emphatic turn.)
7. ...trusting that growth would somehow close the gap. It never did. (Short emphatic sentence added.)
8. The flood destroyed homes, displaced families, and ruined crops. Whole communities were left with nothing. (Combined, then an emphatic follow-up.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

One rewritten paragraph (six to eight sentences) on a current-affairs theme that deliberately varies sentence length, opening, and type, with at least one short emphatic sentence at the key point.

Self-check before you stop:

- Do I vary sentence length, opening, and type on purpose?
- Do I use a short sentence to land my most important idea?
- Do I avoid both choppieness and over-subordination?

Day 29 Error-Spotting Marathon

PHASE 5 • CSS MASTERY • DAY 29 OF 30

Goal: Build the speed and accuracy to detect and correct mixed errors quickly, exactly as the CSS correction question demands.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

The correction question rewards a trained eye that scans for the whole range of errors at once: agreement, tense, articles, prepositions, parallelism, punctuation. Today you drill that integrated eye against the clock.

1. Learn the Rule

A scanning system for mixed errors

Read each sentence twice: once for sense, once for structure. On the structural pass, check in a fixed order subject-verb agreement, tense, articles, prepositions, then punctuation and parallelism.

- *A fixed checking order means you never forget a category under pressure.*
- *Most sentences hide exactly one planted error find it, then move on.*

The high-frequency error families to scan for

These recur across every CSS correction paper. Keep them at the front of your mind.

- *Agreement (Day 4), tense and sequence (Days 5-7), articles (Day 12), prepositions (Day 13)*
- *Parallelism (Day 15), modifiers (Day 11), confused words (Day 21), comparison (Day 20)*

Work fast, then verify

Mark the error on the first pass; only after marking the whole set should you go back to confirm and correct. Hunting and fixing at the same time slows you down.

- *Pass 1: underline the suspect word in each sentence.*
- *Pass 2: write the correction and the one-word reason.*

Today's discipline

Do the twenty-item marathon below in twenty-five minutes. That is roughly seventy-five seconds per sentence real exam pace.

- *Target accuracy: 17 out of 20 or higher.*
- *Note which error family you miss most that is tomorrow's final-revision focus.*

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Method	<i>Read for sense, then scan in a fixed order.</i>	System beats luck under time pressure.
Pace	<i>75 seconds per sentence; 20 items in 25</i>	Trains exam speed, not just accuracy.

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
	<i>minutes.</i>	
Target	<i>17/20 or higher; log your most-missed family.</i>	Diagnose before the final simulation.

MENTOR'S TIP

Time yourself strictly. Accuracy without speed fails the correction question, because you will not finish. Speed without accuracy fails it too. The marathon trains both at once treat the clock as part of the exercise, not an afterthought.

CSS TRAP

Under time pressure, candidates fix the first thing they notice and miss the real planted error. Always complete the structural scan before committing the obvious-looking word is sometimes a decoy, and the actual error is an article or a preposition two words away.

3. Practice Set

Each sentence has exactly one error. Find it, correct it, and name the family. Twenty-five minutes, closed-book.

1. Neither the minister nor his aides was present at the briefing.
2. The committee have submitted their report yesterday.
3. He is one of those leaders who always keeps his word.
4. The data clearly shows that poverty have increased.
5. She insisted that he submits the form immediately.
6. The number of complaints have risen sharply.
7. If he would have studied, he would have passed.
8. The government is committed to implement the reforms.
9. Each of the provinces have its own assembly.
10. He was accused for embezzling public funds.
11. The reforms aim to reduce waste, improving efficiency, and to raise trust.
12. Walking into the hall, the silence struck the candidates.
13. There is less opportunities for graduates this year.
14. The principle of the college addressed the students.
15. Hardly he had arrived when the crisis erupted.
16. The economy is growing since 2021.
17. Between the four options, the third is the best.
18. The cabinet comprised of fifteen ministers.
19. The report, along with its annexes, were tabled in the house.
20. This is the most unique proposal we have received.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. ...nor his aides were present. (Agreement: verb agrees with the nearer subject, aides.)
2. The committee submitted their report yesterday. (Tense: yesterday needs the simple past, not present perfect.)
3. ...who always keeps his word > keep his word. (Agreement: the verb agrees with leaders.)
4. ...poverty has increased. (Agreement: poverty is singular.)
5. ...that he submit the form. (Subjunctive after insisted that.)
6. The number of complaints has risen. (Agreement: the number is singular.)
7. If he had studied, he would have passed. (Conditional: no would in the if-clause.)
8. ...committed to implementing the reforms. (Preposition to + gerund.)
9. Each of the provinces has its own assembly. (Agreement: each is singular.)
10. He was accused of embezzling... (Preposition: accused of.)
11. ...reduce waste, improve efficiency, and raise trust. (Parallelism.)
12. Walking into the hall, the candidates were struck by the silence. (Dangling modifier.)
13. There are fewer opportunities for graduates. (fewer + agreement: opportunities are countable and plural.)
14. The principal of the college... (Confused word: principal = head.)
15. Hardly had he arrived when the crisis erupted. (Inversion after hardly.)
16. The economy has been growing since 2021. (Tense with since.)
17. Among the four options, the third is the best. (among for three or more.)
18. The cabinet comprised fifteen ministers. (comprise, never comprised of.)
19. The report, along with its annexes, was tabled. (Agreement: the subject is report, singular.)
20. This is a unique proposal... (Absolute adjective: no most before unique.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Your marked marathon with a tally by error family, identifying the two families you miss most for targeted revision tonight.

Self-check before you stop:

- Did I finish twenty items in twenty-five minutes?
- Did I score 17 out of 20 or higher?
- Do I know my two weakest error families going into the final day?

Day 30 Final CSS Grammar Simulation

PHASE 5 • CSS MASTERY • DAY 30 OF 30

Goal: Sit a full, mixed, timed grammar paper that integrates every skill from all five phases your dress rehearsal for the exam.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CSS

This is the finish line and the proof. One integrated paper, under time, tells you that thirty days of work have become a single trained instinct. Treat it exactly as you would the real thing.

1. Learn the Rule

Exam conditions

Sixty minutes, closed-book, no breaks. Do all four sections in order. Mark only at the end, against the key, naming every rule.

- Pass mark for confidence: 80% overall, with no section below 75%.
- Treat this as the real paper same silence, same clock, same discipline.

Section A - Correction (Days 1-15, mixed)

Each sentence has one error. Correct it and name the family.

- 1. Neither the report nor the minutes was circulated.
- 2. He insisted that she leaves at once.
- 3. The policy resulted into widespread protest.
- 4. The plan aims to cut costs, improving service, and to raise trust.
- 5. The committee have reached its decision.

Section B - Improvement (Days 16-27, nuance and style)

Rewrite each sentence to improve voice, modality, register, or concision as the bracket directs.

- 6. It was decided by the cabinet that the project would be abandoned. (Improve the voice.)
- 7. This proves the policy worked. (Make it measured.)
- 8. Due to the fact that funds were short, the scheme was cancelled. (Tighten.)
- 9. The govt didn't do much about it. (Fix the register.)
- 10. Corruption is high. Trust is low. Reform is needed. (Combine with flow.)

Section C - Rhetoric and variety (Days 23, 28)

Apply the structure named in brackets.

- 11. The judiciary defended the constitution. (It-cleft.)
- 12. The country has rarely been so divided. (Inversion.)
- 13. The reform failed. It was underfunded. It lacked support. (Combine with variety and one short emphatic sentence.)

Section D - Applied paragraph (integration)

Write one polished paragraph (six to eight sentences) on the prompt, applying everything: accuracy, cohesion, register, concision, variety, and one emphatic structure.

→ 14. Prompt: “Good governance depends on accountability.” Develop this into a single, well-flowing formal paragraph.

2. Model Sentences

Status	Sentence	Why / Correction
Paper	<i>Four sections, fourteen tasks, sixty minutes.</i>	A full integrated grammar paper.
Standard	<i>80% overall, no section below 75%.</i>	The threshold of a trained writer.
Discipline	<i>Closed-book, timed, marked only at the end.</i>	Rehearse the real conditions exactly.

MENTOR'S TIP

Save the last five minutes for a register-and-agreement sweep of Section D, exactly as you will on the real paper. The applied paragraph carries the most weight because it shows integrated skill a single agreement slip or casual word there costs more than a missed correction item. Polish it last.

CSS TRAP

Do not let the open-ended Section D tempt you into over-writing. A tight, correct, well-flowing paragraph with one well-placed emphatic sentence beats a long, ambitious one riddled with small errors. On the real exam, controlled competence outscores reach every time.

3. Practice Set

Complete all four sections under time, then mark against this key, naming each rule and tracing it to its day.

1. Section A key follows items 1-5.
2. Section B key follows items 6-10.
3. Section C key follows items 11-13.
4. Section D judge your paragraph on six axes: accuracy, cohesion, register, concision, variety, and emphasis.
5. Score: total your marks across all sections and convert to a percentage.
6. Diagnose: list every error by day, and note the one phase that still needs work.

4. Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

1. 1. ...nor the minutes were circulated. (Agreement with nearer subject Day 4.)
2. 2. ...that she leave at once. (Subjunctive after insist Day 6.)
3. 3. The policy resulted in widespread protest. (Preposition Day 13.)

4. 4. ...cut costs, improve service, and raise trust. (Parallelism Day 15.)
5. 5. The committee has reached its decision. (Agreement, collective noun Day 4.)
6. 6. The cabinet decided to abandon the project. (Active voice Day 9.)
7. 7. This strongly suggests the policy worked. (Hedged modality Day 19.)
8. 8. Because funds were short, the scheme was cancelled. (Concision Day 25.)
9. 9. The government took little action on it. (Register Day 24.)
10. 10. Corruption is high and trust is low; serious reform is therefore needed. (Cohesion/flow Days 17, 26.)
11. 11. It was the judiciary that defended the constitution. (It-cleft Day 23.)
12. 12. Rarely has the country been so divided. (Inversion Day 23.)
13. 13. Underfunded and unsupported, the reform was doomed. It collapsed. (Variety + short emphatic close Day 28.)
14. 14. Model: "Accountability is the foundation of good governance. Where officials answer for their decisions, public resources are guarded and trust is earned. Where they do not, waste and abuse follow unchecked. Pakistan's own experience bears this out: institutions that face scrutiny perform; those shielded from it decay. What ultimately sustains a state, then, is not the scale of its promises but the strength of its accountability." (Integrates agreement, cohesion, formal register, concision, sentence variety, and a closing what-cleft.)

5. Close the Day

TODAY'S DELIVERABLE

Your complete marked simulation with a final percentage, a full error-by-day log, and a one-paragraph reflection on your readiness and your single remaining priority.

Self-check before you stop:

- Did I score 80% or higher overall, with no section below 75%?
- Is my applied paragraph accurate, formal, and well-flowing?
- Can I now correct, improve, and compose under exam time without hesitation?

Appendix A Daily Error Log

Photocopy or redraw this table for each day. The purpose is to make repeated mistakes visible and therefore removable. After every drill, write the error type, the original sentence, the correction, and a short rule cue you can recall under pressure.

Date	Error type	Original sentence	Corrected sentence	Rule cue

MENTOR'S TIP

Review this log twice a week. When an error type appears three times, it graduates to the front of your revision and you drill it daily until it disappears.

Appendix B 30-Day Progress Tracker

Tick a day only when you have completed all five sections and logged your errors. An honest chain of thirty ticks is the single best predictor of a strong language paper.

Day	Topic	Done	Day	Topic	Done
Day 1	Parts of Speech	☐	Day 2	Sentences & Clauses	☐
Day 3	Punctuation & Caps	☐	Day 4	Subject-Verb Agreement	☐
Day 5	Tenses & Sequence	☐	Day 6	Conditionals & Subjunctive	☐
Day 7	Reported Speech	☐	Day 8	Phase 1 Review	☐
Day 9	Voice & Causatives	☐	Day 10	Verbals	☐
Day 11	Modifiers	☐	Day 12	Articles & Determiners	☐
Day 13	Prepositions & Phrasals	☐	Day 14	Advanced Punctuation	☐
Day 15	Parallel Structure	☐	Day 16	Phase 2 Review	☐
Day 17	Connectors & Cohesion	☐	Day 18	CSS Grammar Traps	☐
Day 19	Modals & Hypotheticals	☐	Day 20	Degrees of Comparison	☐
Day 21	Confused Words	☐	Day 22	Phase 3 Review	☐
Day 23	Cleft & Inversion	☐	Day 24	Register Control	☐
Day 25	Concision	☐	Day 26	Thematic Progression	☐
Day 27	Phase 4 Review	☐	Day 28	Sentence Variety	☐
Day 29	Error-Spotting Marathon	☐	Day 30	Final Simulation	☐

Appendix C High-Yield Formal Replacements

CSS writing rewards precise, formal vocabulary. Replace the casual phrase on the left with the formal alternative on the right but only where it still reads naturally. Formality is a tool, not a costume.

Informal / wordy	Formal / concise	Informal / wordy	Formal / concise
find out	ascertain, determine	look into	investigate, examine
deal with	address, manage	get rid of	eliminate, remove
a lot of	numerous, substantial	bad effect	adverse effect
good for society	beneficial to society	make a decision	decide
because of the fact that	because	in order to	to
at this point in time	currently, now	in the event that	if
put off	postpone, defer	bring about	cause, generate
talk about	discuss, examine	go up / go down	rise / decline
a big problem	a serious / structural problem	think about	consider
enough	sufficient, adequate	keep up	maintain, sustain
cut down on	reduce, curtail	point out	note, indicate
set up	establish, institute	use up	exhaust, deplete

Appendix D Confused-Word Master List

Keep this page open while you write essays. These pairs cause more correction-question losses than any single grammar rule.

Word	Meaning / use	Word	Meaning / use
affect (v.)	to influence	effect (n.)	a result
principal	main; head of an institution	principle	a rule or belief
advice (n.)	guidance	advise (v.)	to give guidance
eminent	distinguished	imminent	about to happen
stationary	not moving	stationery	writing materials
complement	completes / goes with	compliment	praise
economic	relating to the economy	economical	thrifty, efficient
judicial	relating to courts	judicious	wise, prudent
historic	momentous in history	historical	relating to the past
cite	to quote / refer to	site	a location
lose (v.)	to misplace / not win	loose (adj.)	not tight
moral	ethical lesson	morale	spirit, confidence
elicit	to draw out	illicit	unlawful
censure	to criticise formally	censor	to suppress content
ensure	to make certain	insure	to cover against loss
adverse	unfavourable	averse	opposed, reluctant

Appendix E Preposition & Collocation Bank

Learn prepositions in chunks, never as single words. Add five of these to your error log every three days and use them in writing until they are automatic.

Collocation	Collocation	Collocation
comply with	consist of	depend on / upon
differ from	object to	responsible for
capable of	immune to	relevant to
compatible with	conducive to	detrimental to
in accordance with	pursuant to	by virtue of
in relation to	with respect to	on account of
adhere to	refrain from	derive from
consistent with	susceptible to	indicative of
culminate in	grapple with	preside over
a result of	an increase in	a solution to
concerned about (worried)	concerned with (about)	superior to
prefer X to Y	substitute X for Y	deprive of

CSS TRAP

Never translate prepositions directly from Urdu. “Discuss about,” “cope up with,” “emphasise on,” and “married with” are all common Pakistani-English errors. The correct forms are discuss (no preposition), cope with, emphasise (no preposition), and married to.

Appendix F Punctuation Quick Reference

Mark	Core use	Example
Comma	After an introductory clause; to separate list items; before a coordinating conjunction joining two independent clauses.	Although reform was promised, it never arrived.
Semicolon	Joins two closely related independent clauses; separates list items that contain commas.	Institutions matter; personalities cannot sustain reform.
Colon	Introduces an explanation, list, or summary after a complete clause.	The crisis revealed one truth: weak governance is costly.
Dash	Sets off an emphatic or interrupting element. Use sparingly.	Three reforms fiscal, legal, administrative were proposed.
Apostrophe	Possession and contractions. Avoid contractions in formal essays.	the minister's decision; the citizens' demands
Period	Ends a statement; controls sentence boundaries to prevent run-ons.	The policy failed. Implementation was weak.

Appendix G Troublesome Irregular Verbs

Wrong past-participle forms quietly damage formal writing. Memorise these base / past / past-participle sets.

Base	Past	Past participle	Base	Past	Past participle
begin	began	begun	lie (recline)	lay	lain
lay (put)	laid	laid	rise	rose	risen
raise	raised	raised	arise	arose	arisen
lead	led	led	forbid	forbade	forbidden
bear	bore	borne	strive	strove	striven
seek	sought	sought	forsake	forsook	forsaken
bind	bound	bound	tread	trod	trodden
flee	fled	fled	prove	proved	proven / proved

Appendix H Four-Week Maintenance Plan

Grammar mastery fades without contact. After Day 30, run this light maintenance loop for at least four weeks so the gains hold through to the exam.

- Every Sunday: attempt twenty correction items under a timer.
- Twice a week: revise your Daily Error Log and rewrite any item that still feels uncertain.
- Weekly: write one formal paragraph that deliberately uses connectors and parallel structure.
- Every three days: review preposition collocations (Appendix E) and confused words (Appendix D).
- Keep one running page for mistakes that survive past Day 30 that page is your personal exam checklist.

A Final Word

Grammar mastery fades without maintenance. After Day 30, keep one weekly correction test, one précis rewrite, and one essay introduction alive for at least four more weeks. Revise your error log twice a week. The candidate who wins the language paper is not the one who knew the most rules on Day 1 it is the one who stopped repeating the same five mistakes.

Stay disciplined, stay precise.

Ali Hassan Sargana *CSS with Ali Hassan Sargana*